

POWER SHIFTS, STATE BY STATE

BJP's Bengal dream comes true, Vijay flips TN's script

NDA retains Assam and Puducherry; Kerala brings back UDF



PHOTO/PTI

New Bengal govt's swearing-in likely on May 9

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: The BJP is considering May 9—coinciding with 'Pochishe' Boishakh in the Bengali calendar—for the new government's oath-taking ceremony. Sources said Prime Minister Narendra Modi and several senior BJP leaders are likely to attend the swearing-in. Rabindranath Tagore's Jay-anti is traditionally celebrated on the 25th day of the Bengali month Boishakh, known as 'Pochishe' Boishakh. In 2026, it falls on May 9. BJP spent the entire campaign assuring Bengalis that it understood their culture, their language, and their soul, and now, by choosing Tagore's birth anniversary for the swearing-in, it would be an attempt to get

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PM calls for 'change', not 'revenge' after BJP's Bengal victory



PHOTO/PTI

Promises implementation of Ayushman Bharat in 1st Cabinet meet

SOUMYADIP MULLICK

KOLKATA: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday urged political parties in West Bengal to move beyond violence and focus on development, as the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) registered a historic win in the Assembly elections, announcing that the Centre's health insurance scheme Ayushman Bharat-Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY), which provides a cashless cover of Rs 5 lakh per family annually, would be implemented in the state at the first Cabinet meeting. Addressing party workers at the BJP headquarters following victories in West Bengal, Assam and Puducherry, Modi, clad in a kurta and dhoti, said the mandate marked the end of a politics driven by fear. Stressing reconciliation, he said the moment called for "change, not revenge", appealing for an end to the cycle of political violence that has long marred Bengal's electoral landscape. The Prime Minister described the Bengal polls as

'For Change'

- PM Modi, clad in a kurta and dhoti, said the mandate marked the end of a politics driven by fear
- The Prime Minister described the Bengal polls as "special", noting that, unlike previous elections, the process was largely peaceful and free of reported fatalities
- 'Women emerging as a decisive force in Indian democracy'
- Modi also linked the electoral outcome to what he described as public anger against parties opposing the women's reservation law

"special", noting that, unlike previous elections, the process was largely peaceful and free of reported fatalities. He said this reflected growing faith in democratic institutions and a shift in political culture. Modi also linked the electoral

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BIG WINNERS

- Suvendu Adhikari BJP
- C. Joseph Vijay TVK
- Edappadi Palaniswami ADMK
- Himanta Biswa Sarma BJP

BIG LOSERS

- Mamata Banerjee TMC
- Gaurav Gogoi Congress
- Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury Congress
- M K Stalin DMK

Lotus blooms in Bengal: BJP scripts history, clinches 206 seats

Party's vote share rose to 45.56%, up from 38.15% in 2021

SOUMITRA NANDI

KOLKATA: The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) stormed to power in West Bengal, winning 206 seats in the 294-member Assembly. Trinamool Congress (TMC) won 80 seats and was leading in 1 seat at Rajarhat-New Town at the time of going to print. However, the Election Commission of India will conduct repolling for the Falta Assembly seat in South 24-Parganas district on May 21. The Indian National Congress and the Aam Janata Unnayan Party, led by Huma-

yun Kabir, won two seats each. The Left Front opened its account with Md Mostafizur Rahaman's victory in Domkal, while Indian Secular Front (ISF) leader Naushad Siddiqui retained Bhanga. Notably, neither the Left nor Congress had won a seat in 2021. The BJP's two-thirds majority reflects a sharp shift in vote share. According to Election Commission data, the party's vote share rose to 45.56%, up from 38.15% in 2021. TMC's vote share fell to 40.81%, down from 48.02%. In 2021, TMC had won 215 seats against the BJP's 77. Prime Minister Narendra Modi led an aggressive cam-

paign with 14 rallies, including four in a single day across Purulia, Bankura and Jhargram. Union Home minister Amit Shah held 66 rallies and roadshows across 63 locations, focusing on North 24 Parganas, Howrah, Siliguri and Darjeeling, where the BJP registered sweeping wins. Modi said the "winds of change" had swept away the Mamata Banerjee government, promising action against infiltrators and rollout of central health schemes. However, TMC supremo Mamata Banerjee termed the outcome "immoral", alleging irregularities involving the Election

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'WE WILL BOUNCE BACK...'

Mamata accuses BJP of looting over 100 seats, dubs victory 'immoral'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: Calling the saffron party's landslide win in Bengal "an immoral victory", Trinamool Congress (TMC) supremo and outgoing Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee, on the day of counting, levelled big allegations against the BJP and the Election Commission of India (ECI), accusing them of "looting over 100 seats". Speaking to reporters in Kolkata, Banerjee said: "More than 100 seats, the BJP looted. The Election Commission is the BJP's commission."



Mamata Banerjee at the vote counting centre of Bhowanipore. PIC/GAUTAM BOSE

TVK EMERGES GIANT SLAYER

Vijay rewrites Tamil Nadu politics, ends Dravidian dominance

MPOST BUREAU

CHENNAI: In a result that is set to alter the political landscape of Tamil Nadu, actor-politician Vijay led his party, Tamilara Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), to a historic performance in its maiden Assembly election, dislodging the long-standing dominance of the Dravidian majors. The party emerged as the single largest formation, defeating the incumbent

DMK and pushing the AIADMK to a distant third position. The outcome marks the first time since 1967, when the DMK formed the first non-Congress government in the state, that neither of the two Dravidian heavyweights has secured victory in the Assembly polls. Elections were held on April 23, with counting completed on Monday. TVK won 103 seats and was leading in 4 more constituencies



in the 234-member House, putting it within striking distance of the 118 seats required to form the government. The party also secured a vote share of 34.92 per cent, a significant achievement for a formation launched as recently as February 2024. If it assumes office, this would be the first instance in Tamil Nadu of a party coming to power just over two years after its inception.

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TMC GONE, DMK GONE - WHO LEADS THE OPPOSITION

Mixed verdict leaves Opposition searching for the right direction

VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: A string of high-stakes Assembly election results across multiple states has left the Opposition INDIA bloc grappling with a new political reality, as defeats in key strongholds of regional heavyweights have raised fresh questions about leadership, cohesion and strategy within the alliance. The fall of the Trinamool Congress in West Bengal and the DMK in Tamil Nadu, coupled with setbacks for the Left in Kerala, has triggered a moment of introspec-



tion within the INDIA bloc, even as the Congress-led United Democratic Front's victory in Kerala

offers a limited point of relief. The outcome has sharpened a central question reverberating across Opposition ranks: with regional anchors weakened, who now leads the challenge to the BJP? The verdict marks a dramatic reversal of fortunes for parties that, until recently, projected themselves as the backbone of Opposition resistance. Leaders like Mamata Banerjee and M K Stalin had positioned their parties as an effective barrier against the BJP in their respective states for over a decade. Their defeats

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Himanta factor: Assam bucks anti-incumbency

NDA secures two-thirds majority

MPOST BUREAU

GUWAHATI: Bucking anti-incumbency, the BJP-led NDA is set to return to power in Assam for a third consecutive term, sweeping the Assembly polls with a commanding two-thirds majority by winning 102 of the 126 seats on Monday. The Bharatiya Janata Party alone secured 82 seats, with allies Asom Gana Parishad and Bodo Peoples' Front adding 10 each, in a result that cements Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma's hold over the state and reinforces



the NDA's dominance in the Northeast. Sarma won the Jalukbari constituency for the sixth consecutive term, defeating Congress candidate Bidisha Neog by 89,434 votes. In the opposition camp, the Congress won 19 seats, while the Badruddin Ajmal-led

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NDA retains Puducherry, its lone southern segment

PUDUCHERRY: Riding on a pro-incumbency wave, the AINRC-led NDA emerged victorious in the April 9 Puducherry Assembly elections, all set to form the government for a successive term. AINRC leader and Chief Minister N Rangasamy won from both the seats that he contested--Thattanchavady and Mangalam, even as the party won a total of 11 seats and was leading in one, according to latest Election Commission figures. Elections to 30 seats were held on April 9. The territorial assembly also has three nominated members to the House. NDA constituent BJP won from four seats while other coalition members-AIADMK and LJK, won from one seat each. Winners from BJP included party senior and incumbent minister A Namassivayam. The NDA's victory came on a day when actor Vijay-led TVK

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KERALA

UDF ends the LDF dream of 'hattrick'

Lotus blooms in 3 seats

MPOST BUREAU

THIRUVANATHAPURAM: Kerala on Monday witnessed a sharp and decisive political reset as the electors voted out the last Left government in the country, bringing back the Congress to the ruling saddle after a gap of 10 years, while the BJP broke through a long-standing electoral drought by winning three seats. The Congress-led UDF swept aside a decade of Left rule under Pinarayi Vijayan with a decisive Assembly victory, with the national party adding the third southern state to be ruled by it in its kitty. The party is in power in Karnataka and Telangana. Kerala had broken its long tradition of alternating governments when Pinarayi Vijayan won two consecutive terms in 2016 and 2021 — this result ends that brief new pattern.



KEY POINTS

- The UDF secured a commanding 102 seats in the 140-member Assembly
- Outcome marks the first time in five decades that the Left has no government in any Indian state

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'DFS RESCUED ANIMALS AND BIRDS'

April fire cases surge 73%; 32 deaths within 4 months

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Fire-related emergencies in the national capital surged sharply in April, rising 73 per cent from March, while 32 people have died in fire accidents between January and April this year, according to official data.

According to the Delhi Fire Services' (DFS) 'Call Summary 2026', as many as 2,663 fire-related calls were made in April alone, a steep rise compared to 1,538 in March and 1,096 in February. January recorded 1,396 fire calls, taking the total to 6,693 in the first four months of the year.

Overall emergency calls, including fire incidents, animal rescues and other assistance, also peaked in April at 3,914. The cumulative number of calls attended by the DFS stood at 12,008 from January to April. Officials said the spike in April could be linked to rising temperatures and an increase in garbage and dry waste fires. The data showed that incidents involving garbage and rubbish



Despite rising fire incidents, prompt response by personnel helped save 837 lives, with Apr alone accounting for 261 rescues

fires rose from 441 in January to 725 in April, indicating a steady upward trend.

In terms of casualties, March recorded the highest number of deaths due to fire incidents at 15, followed by six each in January and February, and five in April.

In May, at least 10 people have died so far. On May 4, a devastating fire ripped through a residential building in East Delhi's Vivek Vihar, killing nine people from two families, including a toddler. An air-conditioner blast is suspected to have triggered the blaze.

The overall death count across all emergency categories stood at 428 during the period, the data showed.

Despite the rising number of fire-related incidents, prompt response by personnel helped save 837 lives, with April alone accounting for 261 rescues, the highest monthly figure this year, the data showed.

Officials said The Delhi Fire Service also undertook extensive rescue operations involving animals and birds. A total of 1,254 animals and 947 birds were rescued in past the four months.

Fake MBBS admissions racket busted, eighteen NEET aspirants rescued; four fraudsters caught

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police busted an organised racket that allegedly duped NEET aspirants and their families by promising guaranteed MBBS admissions and arrested four people, including the suspected mastermind and a doctor, an official said on Monday.

Eighteen students, which included minors, were rescued from the alleged fraudsters, who had taken them to undisclosed locations on the pretext of providing "exam questions" -- ahead of the NEET (UG) 2026 examination on May 3, police said.

The "fake" question papers were allegedly created using previous years' material and coaching institute content.

They allegedly demanded Rs 20 to 30 lakh from families of the students and took a token payment, claiming to get them guaranteed seats in medical colleges.

The action was initiated following specific input received on May 2 from Surat Police about a suspect operating from Delhi and claiming to facilitate medical admissions through NEET. Technical surveillance



The accused allegedly demanded Rs 20 to 30 lakh from each applicant and collected token payments, documents and cheques as part of the fraud

led investigators to Mahipalpur Extension, where multiple hotels were searched.

The police eventually zeroed in on four accused persons staying at a hotel, including Vinod Bhai Bhikha Bhai Patel, who had allegedly lured aspirants from Gujarat.

During questioning, it emerged that the accused had collected large sums of money, original class 10 and 12 mark sheets, and blank signed cheques from parents in exchange for false assurances of securing MBBS seats.

Investigators said the accused had taken some students away from their guardians. Police laid a trap near a hospital in Ghaziabad and rescued three students while apprehending the alleged mastermind, Santosh Kumar Jaiswal.

Subsequent raids at a flat in Ghaziabad led to the rescue of 15 more students, some of whom were minors scheduled to appear in the NEET exam on May 3. They were counselled and allowed to sit for the examination, police said. Two more

KEY POINTS

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» They were counselled and allowed to sit for the examination, police said. Two more accused -- Sant Pratap Singh and Dr Akhlaq Alam alias Golden Alam -- were arrested from the flat

Three killed, 7-year-old girl hurt in car-truck collision in Gr Noida

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GREATER NOIDA: Three persons, including a woman, were killed and a seven-year-old girl was injured in a collision between a car and a truck on the Eastern Peripheral Expressway in Greater Noida's Dadri area on Monday, police said.

"Four persons -- two men, one woman and a girl -- were travelling from Bhilwara in Rajasthan to Banaras in a

WagonR when the accident occurred," an official at Dadri police station said.

The incident took place around 3 am Monday near the Shahpur underpass on the stretch from Dadri towards Ghaziabad when the car hit the truck from behind, police said. The deceased were identified as Vivek, Ram and Mamta, all residents of Bhilwara in Rajasthan. The girl sustained injuries but is stated to be out of danger, they said.

Toddler dies after falling into open drain

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A two-year-old girl died after allegedly falling into an open drain in outer-north Delhi's Mukundpur area, an official said on Monday.

According to the police, the incident took place on Sunday evening, when the child was playing outside her house. Locals also blamed civic authorities for negligence.

On Sunday evening, the child stepped out of her house in Ishu Vihar to play when she suddenly went missing, police said.



Despite repeated complaints, no permanent measures were taken by the concerned dept to cover the drain: Locals

"Her family members and neighbours searched for several hours but could not trace her. Suspecting that the child might have fallen into a nearby open drain running along the lane, locals and police began searching the drain area. After repeated attempts, the girl was

found stuck in sludge accumulated in the drain," a police officer said.

She was immediately rushed to a nearby government hospital, where doctors declared her dead.

Eyewitnesses said the drain is deep and remains uncov-

ered, posing a constant risk to residents, especially children. Locals claimed that similar incidents had occurred earlier, but timely intervention had prevented fatalities.

Residents alleged that despite repeated complaints, no permanent measures were taken by the concerned department to cover the drain or ensure safety.

They demanded strict action against officials responsible for the alleged lapse and urged authorities to take immediate steps to prevent such incidents in the future.

Civil engineer jumps into canal with 2 sons; one rescued: Cops

Second canal suicide case in two days raises concern

OUR CORRESPONDENT

FARIDABAD: A man allegedly jumped into the Agra Canal near Deeg Fatehpur Billoch village here along with his two sons, one of whom was later found safe on the bank of the canal around 5 km away, police said on Monday, adding that a search is underway for the others.

The incident occurred on Sunday night and came to light when police discovered the man's motorcycle parked on the canal ridge. Upon receiving the information, police and fire brigade teams quickly arrived at the scene to initiate a search operation, police stated.

According to the police, the man who appears to have attempted suicide has been identified as Bhagwat Dayal (35), a civil engineer working for a private company in Ahmedabad, Gujarat. He recently returned home on leave. Police said the man allegedly had ongoing disputes with his wife, which caused him sig-

A person passing through the bridge saw Bhagwat's unattended bike and promptly informed the Faridabad police

nificant distress. However, the family has not provided further details about the situation.

Preliminary investigation suggested that around 9 pm on Sunday night, he had took his sons Samrat (8) and Yug (5) with him under the pretext of a walk in the Sunday market on his bike. But, instead of going to the market, he took the children to the bridge of Agra Canal and jumped, they added.

A passerby passing through the bridge saw Bhagwat's bike and informed the police. After receiving the information, dial 112 and the SDRF team reached the spot and started a search operation in the canal. Then his son Samrat was found safe by the police 5 km away on the bank of the canal, police said.

A senior police officer said that they received informa-

tion from the control room at around 11 pm on Sunday that a man had jumped into the Agra Canal with his two children. After this, they reached the spot and informed the SDRF and fire brigade, he added.

"The man's bike was found parked on a bridge over the Agra Canal. The man is said to be a resident of Asavati village in Palwal. The bike also bears a Palwal registration number. Search is going on, and we are investigating," he said.

This is the same canal into which a dental surgeon jumped and took his own life from the Sector 17 bridge in Faridabad on Saturday. After a 20-hour-long search, the team recovered the doctor's body from the canal on Sunday. It was revealed that the doctor took this step after an argument with his wife.

Five-year-old dies after kite string injury



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A five-year-old child died after sustaining severe injuries caused by a kite string in north-east Delhi's New Usmanpur area, police said.

The incident occurred on May 3 and came to light after a PCR call was received at New Usmanpur police station. The injured child had been admitted to JPC Hospital, where he later succumbed despite treatment.

Preliminary inquiry revealed that the child was riding a motorcycle with his mother and uncle en route to a nearby CNG pump when a sharp kite string fell from above and struck him, causing critical injuries.

Police have registered a case under Sections 106 and 223 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and initiated an investigation to trace the source of the string and identify those responsible.

The incident has once again highlighted the dangers posed by banned or coated kite strings, often made with synthetic material or glass coating, which can cause serious injuries.

Authorities have reiterated the need for strict enforcement and urged the public to avoid their use.

Man apprehended in ₹20L electricity scam

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Cyber Cell of Delhi Police has arrested a key accused in an electricity meter update scam, uncovering a wider inter-state cyber fraud syndicate.

The accused, identified as Dhannajay Gond (30), a resident of Ghazipur in Uttar Pradesh, was held following an investigation into a complaint lodged on March 8 by a Mansarovar Park resident in Shahdara. The victim was duped by fraudsters posing as BSES officials and persuaded to pay Rs 13 via PhonePe on the pretext of updating his electricity meter. Soon after, his phone was compromised, leading to unauthorised transactions totalling over Rs 20 lakh.

Earlier, two co-accused, Shiv Kumar and Anshu Kumar from Firozabad, had been arrested and are in judicial custody. Their interrogation revealed that the stolen money was routed through Common Service Centre (CSC) IDs to obscure the trail.

Acting on these leads,



Two co-accused, Shiv, Anshu Kumar from Firozabad, had been arrested and are in judicial custody

police traced Gond, who allegedly arranged CSC IDs and shared credentials with associates, including one Mahesh Babu, via social media. He admitted facilitating at least four such IDs for commission.

Police have recovered three mobile phones. Further investigation is underway to identify other members and trace the full money trail.

Police nab key accused in Rs 19 lakh ATM heist

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Crime Branch of Delhi Police has arrested a 26-year-old man linked to the Imran Mewati gang in connection with an ATM uprooting and cash theft case in east Delhi. The accused, identified as Robin from Palwal in Haryana, was apprehended after sustained surveillance. Police recovered a Swift Dzire car used in the crime and Rs 22,500 in cash, part of the stolen amount.

The case relates to an ATM in West Vinod Nagar, which had been replenished with Rs 22 lakh on April 29. After legitimate withdrawals of Rs 2.67 lakh, Rs 19.32 lakh remained.



During the intervening night of April 29-30, between 3 am and 3.20 am, the accused used a gas cutter to break open the ATM and decamped with the cash.

Investigators tracked the gang through CCTV footage and technical inputs. Robin confessed during interrogation. Efforts are underway to arrest other accused and recover the remaining cash.

DIPIKA KIROLA

GREATER NOIDA: The Greater Noida Authority has approved a hike in land allotment rates across residential and other categories, making property purchases in premium sectors significantly more expensive. The revised rates were cleared at the Authority's board meeting on Saturday as part of efforts to boost revenue, and will come into effect once a formal office order is issued.

Under the new structure,



sectors have been classified into four groups -- A, B, C and D -- based on location and availability of civic amenities. Group A sectors, considered the most upscale, will see residential allotment rates rise to Rs 51,363 per square metre. Despite the increase, officials noted that the

'Authority plans to roll out new schemes, including residential plots, under the updated rate structure. Officials said the reclassification aims to align pricing with infra dev, improve transparency...'

revised rates remain below prevailing market prices, where resale values in several prime areas have already crossed Rs 1 lakh per square metre.

The Authority plans to roll out new schemes, including residential plots, under the updated rate structure. Officials

Gr Noida society faces water woes

GREATER NOIDA: A two-day water shortage at a residential society in Greater Noida has raised concerns over the reliability of basic amenities in premium housing complexes.

The issue surfaced after a resident shared a video from Panchsheel Greens II, showing a water tanker deployed as a temporary measure. The resident, Aadhar Mehrotra, said there was no water supply for two consecutive days, forcing authorities to rely on tanker services to meet daily needs.

In the video, he expressed frustration over the disruption and criticised the developer, highlighting the gap between

promised facilities and actual conditions. The clip quickly gained traction on social media, with several users saying such problems are common across societies in Noida and Greater Noida. Residents noted that despite paying regular maintenance charges, they continue to face recurring issues related to water supply, electricity and incomplete infrastructure. While tanker supply offered temporary relief, residents said it does not address the root cause, reviving concerns over accountability and service delivery in high-rise developments marketed as premium housing.

MPOST

Greater Noida hikes land allotment rates; premium sectors may witness sharp rise

Rates to take effect after office order; industrial, commercial, institutional land rates also revised

egories similarly divided into sector-based groups and pricing linked to location and plot size.

For industrial land, the minimum allotment rate has been increased to Rs 10,789 per square metre from Rs 10,416 earlier, reflecting rising demand and ongoing infrastructure expansion in Greater Noida. The move is expected to impact new buyers and investors, particularly in high-end sectors, while still offering some margin compared to current market rates.

SUMMER SURGE: CM Rekha Gupta warns of action on water lapses

HOLDS HIGH-LEVEL REVIEW MEET



AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: With Delhi heading into peak summer and water demand set to surge, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday issued a stern warning to officials, making it clear that any negligence in water supply or complaint redressal will invite strict action. Chairing a high-level review meeting at the Secretariat, the Chief Minister emphasised both immediate preparedness and long-term solutions to tackle the Capital's recurring water woes.

"We're not just offering short-term relief, but working to end Delhi's water crisis for good," Gupta said, underlining the government's dual focus on crisis management and structural reform. "Government is fully committed to ensuring clean and adequate water for every citizen," she added.

The meeting, attended by Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh, Chief Secretary Rajiv Verma and senior Delhi Jal Board officials, reviewed the status of key projects and summer preparedness. Gupta

“We're not just offering short-term relief, but working to end Delhi's water crisis for good
— CM Rekha Gupta

directed all major water treatment plants, including Sonia Vihar, Bhagirathi, Chandrawal, Wazirabad, Haiderpur, Nangloi, Okhla, Bawana and Dwarka, to operate at peak capacity to ensure uninterrupted supply. Coordination with Haryana is also underway to monitor ammonia levels in raw water, a critical factor in maintaining treatment efficiency.

Highlighting the scale-up in infrastructure, the Chief Minister said operational tubewells have increased from 5,834 to 6,200, while water tankers have been expanded from 1,166 to 1,210, with an additional 100 on standby. Fixed supply points have risen significantly from 8,700 to 13,000. High-demand

areas such as Sangam Vihar, Chhatarpur, Deoli, Palam and Bawana are receiving targeted attention through constituency-specific deployment plans. To strengthen response systems, the government has reinforced its grievance redressal mechanism with 24x7 helplines (1916 and 1800117118), ensuring complaints are routed directly to field engineers with mandatory feedback. A central control room, chatbot-based system and PPP-mode call centres have also been introduced. Additionally, 28 water emergency centres are now operational round the clock across the city.

Gupta also directed officials to fast-track long-term projects, including the commissioning of a second 50 MGD water treatment plant in Dwarka and a 2 MGD recycling plant in Bawana. She highlighted that 520 new tubewells have been installed and 172 km of old pipelines replaced in 2025–26. Efforts such as leak detection drives, sewer cleaning and reservoir maintenance are also underway to ensure a more resilient water supply system.

Mayor Pravesh Wahi inspects Pooth Khurd

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Mayor Pravesh Wahi on Monday conducted an inspection of Ward No. 29 in Pooth Khurd, focusing on sanitation challenges and pending civic works. The visit forms part of an ongoing series of field inspections aimed at strengthening basic infrastructure and public service delivery in rural pockets of the Capital.

During the inspection, the Mayor interacted with residents of Prahladpur village, listening to their grievances related to poor sanitation, clogged drains, and incomplete street construction. Assuring prompt action, Wahi directed officials of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi and the Public Works Department to work in close coordination, particularly on interconnecting drainage systems to prevent water logging and unhygienic conditions.

Accompanied by local councillor Anju Devi and senior civic



officials, the Mayor emphasised that all complaints must be addressed within a stipulated timeframe. He warned that delays in ongoing construction projects would invite strict action, including the blacklisting of contractors if necessary. Officials present at the site assured completion of pending works within a week.

Wahi also inspected an MCD school in Barwala village and instructed authorities to repair the damaged boundary wall at the earliest.

Delhi hosts ‘Beat Plastic Pollution’ WORKSHOP

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Environment Department on Monday organised a one-day “Beat Plastic Pollution” workshop, bringing together policymakers, experts, educators, and over 150 students to discuss sustainable solutions to plastic waste. The initiative aligns with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta's vision of building a cleaner and more sustainable capital.

Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa praised the department's efforts and commended students for their creativity and active participation. “Removing single-use plastics is essential for Delhi's clean future. Your creativity today inspires lasting change,” he said.

The event began with a ceremonial lamp-lighting and a welcome song by students of Bal Bhavan Public School, Mayur Vihar Phase-II. It featured a mix of educational and cultural activities, including

CM seeks seamless conduct of 2 int’l Summits

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A high-level review meeting was held at the Delhi Secretariat under the chairmanship of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta to assess preparations for the upcoming 4th India-Africa Forum Summit (IAFS-IV) and the 1st International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) Summit, scheduled from May 28 to June 1, 2026.

The meeting focused on ensuring that all arrangements for the international events meet the highest standards, reflecting Delhi's readiness to host global leaders and delegates. Senior officials from multiple departments were present and were instructed to maintain seamless coordination

HIGHLIGHTS

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- » Senior officials from multiple departments were present and were instructed to maintain seamless coordination across agencies

» The Chief Minister directed officials to establish a 24x7 control room for continuous monitoring and swift response to any issues during the summit period



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trol room for continuous monitoring and swift response to any issues during the summit

period. Nodal officers are to be appointed across departments to ensure accountability and efficient execution of responsibilities. Real-time monitoring systems will also be put in place to track progress and address challenges promptly.

Special emphasis was laid on improving cleanliness and public amenities across the city, particularly in key markets, major roads, and prominent tourist destinations that are expected to witness increased footfall during the summits. Officials were asked to ensure that sanitation, waste management, and civic infrastructure are maintained at optimal levels.

The government also stressed the importance of

enhancing the overall visitor experience, including better traffic management, signage, and public convenience facilities. Departments were instructed to work proactively to avoid disruptions and ensure smooth movement of delegates.

The upcoming summits are expected to position Delhi as a significant venue for international diplomacy and cooperation. The India-Africa Forum Summit aims to strengthen ties between India and African nations, while the IBCA Summit will focus on global efforts towards big cat conservation.

The review meeting concluded with directions for regular follow-ups to ensure timely completion of all preparations.

MCD earmarks ₹48 cr for garbage CLEANUP

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has allocated Rs 48 crore to augment resources for waste and sanitation management across multiple zones in the city for 2026–27, according to an official order.

The order issued on April 27 states that the allocation, cleared with the approval of the MCD Commissioner, will fund a range of sanitation works, including hiring of vehicles, machinery and manpower for garbage collection, lifting and transportation under challenging conditions across various wards.

In the West Zone, the civic body has sanctioned hiring of 50 light motor vehicles with auto-tipping facilities and an additional 30 medium motor vehicles, along with backhoe loaders for garbage removal.

For Shahdara (South), provisions have been made for the deployment of 52 vehicles, including tipper trucks, loaders and sanitation workers for the

collection and transportation of mixed waste over six months, while Najafgarh Zone will see hiring of CNG-run vehicles, eight HYVA trucks and loaders for clearing garbage and silt from roads and footpaths.

Similar measures have been planned for Central, Shahdara (North), South, Narela, Keshavpuram, Rohini and Civil Lines zones, focusing on improving sanitation at garbage vulnerable points and cleanliness target units.

According to officials, the MCD currently collects roughly 13,000 metric tons of garbage daily, but when it conducts cleanliness drives, this amount exceeds 15,000 metric tons per day.

The MCD has accorded in-principle approval for these 10 zones' works and permitted these zones to invite separate tenders. Administrative approval and expenditure sanction have also been granted for individual projects as per the estimated costs indicated, the order stated.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Overnight thunderstorms and rain, accompanied by gusty winds, brought temperatures down across Delhi on Monday, with the minimum temperature dipping several notches below normal, according to the India Meteorological Department.

At Safdarjung, the city's base station, the minimum temperature was recorded at 18.8 degrees Celsius, 5.9 notches below normal, IMD data showed.

Palam recorded a low of 17.9 degrees Celsius, 7.7 degrees below normal, while The Ridge logged a minimum temperature of 18 degrees Celsius, down by 7 degrees.

Lodi Road recorded a minimum of 20 degrees Celsius, 3 degrees below normal, and Ayanagar 19 degrees Celsius, 4.6 notches below normal, according to the IMD.

Rain lashed several areas in Delhi between late night and early morning hours. Safdarjung recorded around 5.7 mm of rain in the last 24 hours till 8.30 am on Monday, while Palam received about 5.7 mm.

GRAP-1 restrictions revoked

NEW DELHI: GRAP-1 restrictions in Delhi-NCR have been revoked after a significant improvement in air quality, officials said on Monday. The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) said that owing to favourable meteorological conditions, the air quality index (AQI) of Delhi was recorded at 88 on Monday. “Further, the forecast by IMD and IITM indicates that AQI is likely to remain in the moderate category in the coming days,” an official said.

GRAP-1 restrictions have been in force following an order issued on April 16.

The development means that restrictions such as a ban on the use of coal and firewood as fuel in tandoors in hotels, restaurants, and open eateries, and the use of diesel generators only in emergency or essential situations will no longer be in place.

There are four stages in GRAP, each linked to the AQI at the time. The first stage, GRAP-1, kicks in when the AQI is between 201 and 300; the second stage, GRAP-2, is invoked when the AQI is between 301 and 400; GRAP-3 kicks in between 401 and 500; and GRAP-4 is invoked when the AQI is more than 450. **MP05T**

Among the other stations, Ayanagar recorded the highest rainfall at 13 mm, followed by Lodi Road and The Ridge at 4 mm each.

The maximum temperature in Delhi on Monday is likely to be in the range of 31-33 degrees Celsius, according to the IMD. Delhi's air quality was 'mod-

erate' on Monday morning with an AQI reading of 106, according to Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) data.

The CPCB classifies an AQI between 0 and 50 as 'good', 51 and 100 'satisfactory', 101 and 200 'moderate', 201 and 300 'poor', 301 and 400 'very poor', and 401 and 500 'severe'.

CONGRATULATES PM MODI, SHAH, NABIN

CM Gupta cheers BJP's ‘double dhamaka’ in Bengal and Assam

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Celebrating the Bharatiya Janata Party's sweeping victories in West Bengal and Assam, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday termed the results a “historic mandate” and a decisive endorsement of development-driven governance under Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Welcoming the outcome, Gupta congratulated Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah and BJP national president Nitin Nabin, crediting their leadership for the party's electoral success. She said the verdict reflects growing public faith in welfare policies and transparent governance. “People have moved beyond empty slogans, divisive narratives and hollow claims of



secularism,” she said, adding that voters have chosen “tangible development, transparency and results-oriented governance.”

Marking the occasion, the Chief Minister celebrated with her cabinet colleagues at the Delhi Secretariat, where the mood was festive with traditional Bengali snacks like jhalmuri and rosogulla being shared. She expressed confi-

dence that the momentum in favour of development politics would continue across the country.

Highlighting the implications for West Bengal, Gupta said the state is now poised to benefit fully from central government schemes. “West Bengal will now move forward on a rapid growth trajectory, much like Delhi,” she said, suggesting

that the new mandate would ensure better implementation of flagship programmes.

She pointed to major initiatives such as Jan Dhan Yojana, Ujjwala Yojana, Ayushman Bharat, Digital India and Atmanirbhar Bharat as key drivers of socio-economic transformation. According to her, these schemes have significantly improved the lives of the poor, farmers, women and youth, while also strengthening India's global standing.

Calling the victory more than just an electoral outcome, the Chief Minister said it signals a broader shift in public sentiment towards stability and performance-based governance. “This is a clear endorsement of public trust in the leadership and policies that focus on inclusive growth,” she said.



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JAISHANKAR ARRIVED IN KINGSTON ON SATURDAY

EAM Jaishankar meets Jamaican PM, gifts over 10 BHISHM Cubes

KINGSTON: External Affairs minister S Jaishankar on Monday met Jamaican Prime Minister Andrew Holness and discussed ways to further deepen “political, economic and people-to-people cooperation.”

Jaishankar also conveyed greetings from Prime Minister Narendra Modi to Holness.

“Pleased to call on Prime Minister @AndrewHolnessJ in Kingston. Conveyed the greetings of PM @narendramodi,” Jaishankar posted on X.



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar addresses the gathering during the dedication of an electronic scoreboard at Sabina Park, in Kingston, Jamaica

Highlights

- » He also highlighted the cricket bond between both countries as India gifted a scoreboard to Jamaica
- » The minister expressed hope that the new scoreboard would witness many memorable innings, including those symbolising the enduring friendship between the two countries

“Discussed deepening our political, economic and people-to-people cooperation. Value his commitment towards further strengthening India-Jamaica relations,” the post further read.

Also, the external affairs minister handed over 10 BHISHM (Bharat Health Initiative for Sahyog Hita & Mai-

tri) Cubes as a gift to Jamaica. “Formally handed over 10 BHISHM Cubes as a gift from India to Jamaica, in the presence of PM @AndrewHolnessJ, Health Minister @

christufton and FM @kaminajsmith,” Jaishankar posted on X.

“The BHISHM Cube mobile hospital system, designed for rapid deploy-

ment, will help Jamaica during disasters and emergencies. The gift of these cubes is a statement of friendship, a commitment to disaster preparedness, and an outcome of innovation,” the post said.

Jaishankar arrived in Kingston on Saturday evening, marking the first leg of his nine-day tour of Jamaica, Suriname, and Trinidad and Tobago, aimed at further strengthening India’s strategic and cultural ties with the Caribbean nations.

Earlier in the day, he interacted with the Indian diaspora and discussed India’s ongoing transformation in infrastructure, human development and technology-driven governance and entrepreneurship with them.

He also highlighted the cricket bond between both countries as India gifted a scoreboard to Jamaica.

A scoreboard was dedicated at Sabina Park in Kingston. It is the home of the Jamaica cricket team and is the only Test cricket ground in the Caribbean island nation.

The minister expressed hope that the new scoreboard would witness many memorable innings, including those symbolising the enduring friendship between the two countries.

Cricket has long been a strong cultural bridge between India and Jamaica, which is part of the West Indies cricket team.

Jamaican players, including Chris Gayle, Courtney Walsh and Michael Holding, have played a major role in shaping the legacy of West Indies cricket in the international arena, contributing to its dominance in earlier decades and its continued global appeal.

‘APPROACH THE CALCUTTA HIGH COURT...’

Supreme Court declines plea for Central Forces in Bengal

OUR CORRESPONDENT



KOLKATA: The Supreme Court of India on Monday refused to entertain a plea seeking deployment of Central Forces to curb possible post-poll violence, directing the petitioner to approach the Calcutta High Court instead.

The matter was mentioned before a Bench led by Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice Joy-malya Bagchi.

Senior Advocate V Giri, appearing for an organisation, flagged concerns of a repeat of the violence reported after the 2021 Assembly polls and sought preventive directions, including the setting up of a monitoring mechanism to oversee adequate security deployment after results are declared.

The Bench, however, declined to intervene at this stage, emphasising that issues relating to law and order fall squarely within the domain of the state. It advised the peti-

tioner to seek appropriate relief from the High Court, which it indicated was better placed to address such concerns locally.

During the brief hearing, counsel appearing for the Election Commission of India submitted that the Commission’s mandate is limited to the conduct of elections and effectively ends with the completion of the counting process. This submission was noted by the Bench.

The petitioner argued that the apprehension of violence was not speculative, citing past incidents and seeking urgent intervention through an interlocutory application

Observing that the state machinery is responsible for maintaining public order, the Bench expressed an expectation that authorities would act in accordance with their Constitutional duties

in a pending writ petition. The court, however, maintained its position and declined to expand the scope of the ongoing proceedings.

Observing that the state machinery is responsible for maintaining public order, the Bench expressed an expectation that authorities would act in accordance with their Constitutional duties.

It also noted that the main petition is already scheduled for hearing later this month.

From Page 1

Lotus blooms in Bengal

Commission and Central Forces.

Among BJP heavyweights, Suwendu Adhikari won Nandigram and defeated Banerjee in Bhowanipore by 15,105 votes (73,917 to 58,812). Other winners included Agnimitra Paul (Asansol Dakshin), Swapan Dasgupta (Rashbehari), Rudranil Ghosh (Shibpur), Dilip Ghosh (Kharagpur Sadar), Sankar Ghosh (Siliguri) and Nisith Pramanik (Mathabhanga).

Several TMC ministers lost. Siddiqullah Chowdhury (Monteswar) lost to BJP’s Saikat Panja by 14,798 votes; Chandrima Bhat-tacharya lost by 26,404 votes; Sujit Bose by 37,330; Shashi Panja by 14,633; Bratya Basu by 25,273 in Dum Dum; Aroop Biswas by 6,000 in Tollygunge; Swapan Deb-nath, Bankim Chandra Hazra (Sagar), Birbaha Hansda (Bin-pur), Becharam Manna (Singur), Udayan Guha (Dinhata), Indranil Sen (Chandannagar) and Snehasis Chakraborty (Jangipara, by 862 votes) also lost.

In Kolkata’s 11 seats, BJP won 6 while TMC secured 5, unlike 2011 when TMC had swept all. However, ministers like Sobhandeb Chat-topadhyay (Ballygunge), Firhad Hakim (Kolkata Port), Pulak Roy (Uluberia Dakshin) and Javed Ahmed Khan (Kasba) retained their seats.

In Behala, BJP’s Sandip Sarkar won Behala East, and Indranil Khan won Behala West. Sarbori Mukherjee won Jadavpur.

Though TMC had won 29 of 42 Lok Sabha seats in 2024 (BJP 12), analysts point to anti-incumbency and key events.

The 2024 RG Kar Medical College rape-murder case triggered mass protests, while the Supreme Court’s 2025 order upholding the cancellation of over 25,000 teacher appointments revived corruption allegations linked to former minister Partha Chatterjee.

New Bengal

a message across. Though the BJP has not officially confirmed a date yet.

The speculation began with a remark Modi made at his final rally in Barrackpore on April 27 — the last day of campaigning. “This is my last rally in this election. I’m going back with the confidence that I will definitely attend the BJP’s swearing-in ceremony after the May 4 results. And that only increases my enthusiasm,” Modi had said from an election rally.

Before the first BJP government is installed in the state, outgoing Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee will formally meet the Governor and offer to resign. The Governor, in accordance with the provisions of the Constitution, is expected to ask her to continue as a caretaker Chief Minister until the formation of the new government, thus ensuring administrative continuity.

Besides PM Modi, several high-profile leaders are also expected to attend the swearing-in of the new Chief Minister and the Council of ministers.

Suwendu Adhikari and some other top BJP leaders from Bengal are expected to fly to Delhi on Tuesday to discuss with the central leaders the details about the swearing-in ceremony and distribution of portfolios of Cabinet ministers.

Mamata

not doing anything. Do you think this is a victory? It is an immoral victory, not a moral victory. Whatever the Election Commission has done, along with the Central Forces and the PM & Home Minister, is totally illegal. It is loot, loot, loot. We will bounce back,” said Banerjee who later lost the Bhowanipore seat to BJP’s Suwendu Adhikari.

TMC national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee also visited Sakhawati Memorial Government High School, and the ECI urged him to leave the place as he was not a candidate nor a counting agent.

The BJP supporters shouted “thief” slogan at him. Speaking to the media, he said that the party would accept the public mandate while simultaneously flagging concerns about “unusually slow” counting.

“Let people’s verdict come. We will accept it. We will also look into the loopholes. In the first eight and a half hours in 2021, almost 90 per cent of the counting was done. Today, till 4.15 pm, in the past eight and a half hours, only 4 to 8 rounds of counting were done. In Burdwan South, TMC won, I was told, but a recount was ordered there. 17C Forms did not match with the control unit in eight machines in Kalyani,” Abhishek added.

PM calls for ‘change’

outcome to what he described as public anger against parties opposing the women’s reservation law, asserting that voters—particularly women—had “punished” rivals, including the Indian National Congress and the Trinamool Congress (TMC). He added that a similar sentiment could impact future contests, including in Uttar Pradesh.

Highlighting high female turnout, Modi said women were emerging as a decisive force in Indian democracy. He criticised opposition parties for blocking amendments to the Nari Shakti Vandan legislation, calling it a setback to women’s empowerment and inclusive governance.

Expanding the scope beyond Bengal, Modi said the BJP-led National Democratic Alliance had retained power in Assam for a third consecutive term and secured a mandate in Puducherry on a development-focused agenda. He framed the results as a broader endorsement of governance and stability.

Invoking a symbolic geographical arc, Modi said BJP governments now govern states along the Ganga belt—from Uttarakhand to West Bengal—signalling the party’s expanding footprint.

Calling the outcome a “new chapter,” Modi credited party workers for the victory and said the results honoured the legacy of Syama Prasad Mookerjee. He reiterated that electoral wins and losses were part of democracy but emphasised that the people had reaffirmed faith in performance-driven politics, strengthening democratic par-

ticipation and public trust across regions.

Vijay rewrites

Vijay himself contested and won from both Perambur and Tiruchirappalli East constituencies. He is also set to become the first Chief Minister from a Christian background in the state. The scale of TVK’s performance was underlined by its penetration into regions traditionally dominated by rivals, including western Tamil Nadu, an AIADMK stronghold that includes Coimbatore.

One of the most striking upsets came in Kolathur, where Chief Minister M K Stalin was defeated by V S Babu, a former DMK member and ex-MLA, by a margin of 8,795 votes. Stalin had not faced electoral defeat since 1991. The DMK also saw more than 10 ministers lose their seats, including P Geetha Jeevan and Ma Subramanian.

Deputy Chief Minister Udhayanidhi Stalin faced a tense contest in Chepauk-Thiruvallikeni, trailing the TVK candidate for a period before eventually securing a win.

The DMK finished with 48 seats and was leading in 12 more, securing a vote share of 24.20 per cent. Accepting the verdict, Stalin said his party bowed to the people’s decision. “We were truthful to all sections and worked for their welfare to the best of our ability,” he said, adding that the DMK would now function as a strong opposition. “In public life, I have seen both victories and defeats. Our journey will continue without slackness. Ideology is important, not just electoral outcomes,” he said.

The AIADMK, led by Edappadi K Palaniswami, won 41 seats and was leading in six constituencies, with a vote share of 21.25 per cent. Palaniswami himself registered a decisive victory from Edapadi in Salem district, winning by a margin of 98,110 votes. While senior leaders such as C Ve Shanmugam and SP Velumani secured comfortable wins, several others, including former minister P Thangamani, were defeated.

Reacting to the outcome, Palaniswami said, “I wholeheartedly accept the decision given by the people. They are the judges in a democracy.” He also expressed confidence that the party would recover from the setback.

As TVK edged towards a landmark debut victory, celebrations erupted outside the party’s office in Panaiyur, where supporters burst firecrackers and distributed sweets. The party’s promise of sharing power with like-minded groups is expected to shape the next phase of government formation. The Congress, IUML, Left parties, VCK and PMK together accounted for 18 seats, and are seen as potential allies.

Among notable TVK winners was actor-director Srinath, who defeated minister P Geetha Jeevan in Thoothukudi. The party’s success also drew congratulations from film personalities, including Rajinikanth, Dhanush and Anirudh Ravichander.

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UDF ends the LDF

Apart from strong anti-incumbency against the government, the results of the April 9 polls also indi-

cated a consolidation of support across sections of society in favour of the United Democratic Front, which had been in opposition to the Left dispensation for the past decade.

The UDF won 102 seats, while the CPI(M)-headed LDF netted 35 seats, according to Election Commission data on counting of votes for 140 constituencies.

The outcome also marked the absence of the Left from governance in any Indian state for the first time in five decades. The ire against the government was so strong that 13 ministers in the cabinet suffered defeat in the political tsunami unleashed by the UDF.

Not only the Congress, but its key allies, including the IUML, the Kerala Congress also secured massive victory in the polls, which saw the complete erasure of the LDF in some key districts.

At the same time, the LDF partners, including the CPI(M), lost many seats, while a key partner, Kerala Congress (M), was reduced to zero in a humiliating outcome in the polls.

Top contenders for the Chief Minister’s post, senior Congress leader Ramesh Chennithala and Leader of Opposition V D Sathes-an, won their seats with comfortable margins, setting the stage for the next step in discussions on the post.

Of the 21 cabinet members, only Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan, P A Mohamed Riyas, K Rajan, G R Anil, K N Balagopal, P Prasad, and Saji Cherian emerged victorious.

The ministers who lost the election included Veena George, M B Rajesh, O R Kelu, R Bindhu, J Chinchurani, P Rajeev, K B Ganesh Kumar, V N Vasavan, V Sivankutty, V Abdurahiman, Kadannappally Ramachandran A K Saseendran and Roshy Augustine.

The BJP’s bid to make strong inroads in Kerala dominated by UDF and LDF got a slight push with the party winning three seats—Nemom and Kazhakoottam in Thiruvananthapuram district and Chathannoor in Kollam.

The BJP candidate from Chathannoor, B B Gopakumar, won by 4,398 votes. In Nemom, party state chief Rajeev Chandrasekhar triumphed with a margin of over 3,000 votes, while former Union Minister V Muraliedharan won Kazhakoottam with a narrow margin.

Congress general secretary and Wayanad MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra thanked the people of the state for their overwhelming support and vowed to work diligently towards building a better future for them.

NDA retains Puducherry

won in neighbouring Tamil Nadu and also emerged victorious from two seats in the UT.

Puducherry, a tiny UT located about 160 km from Chennai, borders Tamil Nadu districts Cuddalore and Villupuram on either sides.

Opposition DMK won five seats and Congress one.

While the CM trounced Neyamakkal Kazhagam rival E Vinayagam by 4441 votes in Thattanchavady, his pocket borough seat, Rangasamy emerged victorious in Managalam too, defeating DMK’s SS Rangan by 7050 votes.

This is not the first time that

Rangasamy has sought to contest from two seats.

He contested in Yanam and Thattanchavady in the 2021 Assembly polls. He however was trounced in Yanam and was successful in Thattanchavady.

He may have to now vacate one of the seats.

Key losers include former CM Ve Vaithilingam at the hands of Rangasamy.

Himanta factor

AIUDF and Akhil Gogoi-led Rajior Dal secured two seats each, and the Trinamool Congress bagged one constituency.

In a major blow to the Congress, its state president Gaurav Gogoi lost in Jorhat to veteran politician and sitting BJP MLA Hitendranath Goswami by 23,181 votes.

Among the prominent BJP winners are ministers Ajanta Neog (Golaghat), Ranajo Pegu (Dhemajji), Pijush Hazarika (Jagiroad), Kaushik Rai (Lakhipur), Prashanta Phukan (Dibrugarh), Krishnendu Paul (Patharkandi) and Bimal Borah (Tingkhong).

Assembly Speaker Biswajit Daimary won from Tamulpur constituency by defeating former BTC chief Pramod Boro of the UPPL.

Sitting MLAs Mrinal Saikia (Khumtai), Bhuvan Pegu (Jonai), Rama Kant Dewri (Morigaon), Rupak Sarmah (Nagaon-Batadraba), Paramanda Rajbongshi (Sipajhar), Utpal Borah (Gohpur), Biswajit Phukan (Sarupathar), Binod Hazarika (Chabua-Lahowal), Taranga Gogoi (Naharkatia), Bhaskar Sharma (Margherita), Rupyoti Kurmi (Mariani) and Bhuvan Gam (Majuli) also emerged victorious.

AGP ministers Atul Bora and Keshav Mahanta retained their Bokakhat and Kaliabor constituencies, respectively, while first-timer Tapan Das won the Dimoria seat. Congress candidates Asif Mohammad Nazar and Aftabuddin Mollah won from Laharighat and Jaleswar constituencies, respectively. AIUDF chief Badrudin Ajmal won from Binna-kandi and Mazibur Rahman from Dalgao.

Rajior Dal president Akhil Gogoi retained the Sibsagar seat, while another party member Mehbub Muktar won the Dhing seat and Trinamool Congress’ Sherman Ali Ahmed won from Mandia.

Among the prominent candidates who lost the polls are Leader of the Opposition in the outgoing Assembly, Debabrata Saikia, Assam Jatiya Parishad president Lurinjyoti Saikia, and former Rajya Sabha MP and senior Congress leader Ripun Bora.

Polling in all 126 Assembly constituencies in the state was held in a single phase on April 9.

The BJP-led NDA’s return to power in Assam has reinforced the state as the party’s strongest base in the Northeast and validated Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma’s governance model.

This is the first time since Independence that an alliance bagged more than 100 seats, or a single party other than the Congress secured an absolute majority on its own.

All other earlier non-Congress governments, including the two BJP regimes of 2016 and 2021,

did not have any party getting the majority mark single-handedly.

The saffron party’s campaign centred on curbing illegal immigration, eviction drives, and “identity, land and security” issues, claiming it freed 1.5 lakh bighas of land from “Bangladeshi encroachers”.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah promised to deport “every infiltrator” within five years if the BJP remains in power. This victory signals voter approval of that narrative.

Also, the win of this magnitude will surely give Sarma political capital to continue his “push-back” operations and evictions, which BJP leaders say will continue more aggressively in the next five years.

Mixed verdict

now represent what many within the alliance describe as one of the toughest political nights for regional stalwarts in recent years.

The Bharatiya Janata Party’s breakthrough in West Bengal carries particular national significance. The state, which sends 42 members to the Lok Sabha, had long remained beyond the BJP’s grasp. Its capture not only expands the party’s geographical footprint but could also strengthen its position in the Rajya Sabha over time. The Trinamool Congress, once a dominant force, trailed the BJP by nearly five percentage points, underscoring the scale of the reversal. In Tamil Nadu, the DMK’s loss adds to the narrative of a shifting political landscape in the south. Attempts within sections of the Congress to explore an alternative alliance with actor-turned-politician Vijay and his Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam did not materialise electorally, though some leaders maintained that such a combination could have yielded better results. “A combination of Rahul Gandhi and Vijay would have swept Tamil Nadu,” Congress leader Praveen Chakravathy said, reflecting internal debates that may now intensify.

The Congress did manage to secure a morale boost in Kerala, where the UDF unseated the CPI(M)-led Left Democratic Front. The result leaves the Left without control of any state for the first time since 1977, marking a historic low for a key Opposition constituent. Despite this win, the broader national picture remains challenging for the Congress, which has faced a series of electoral setbacks in states such as Maharashtra, Delhi, Haryana and Bihar in recent months.

The mixed outcome comes at a time when the INDIA bloc had briefly demonstrated unity and effectiveness at the national level. Less than a month ago, Opposition parties coordinated to block the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill in Parliament. That effort required intense negotiation, including intervention from Rahul Gandhi, who pushed allies like the TMC to ensure sufficient attendance in the Lok Sabha. The episode had revealed underlying tensions, with some regional leaders privately questioning Congress’s authority to steer the alliance.

Those tensions now appear set to evolve. With the electoral setbacks weakening regional parties that had earlier challenged Congress’s leadership, the likelihood of an immediate leadership contest within the bloc has diminished.

At the same time, the defeats have exposed the fragility of an alliance built on both shared opposition to the BJP and competing regional ambitions.

The Congress’s own performance reflects the complexity of the situation. In West Bengal, it secured around 3.12 per cent of the vote and won two seats in the Murshidabad region, while polling 3.38 per cent in Tamil Nadu. In Assam, where the BJP retained power with a two-thirds majority under Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma, the Congress garnered approximately 29.5 per cent of the vote but is expected to win fewer seats than in the previous election. In Kerala, its vote share stood at about 28.8 per cent. The Assam result, in particular, adds to concerns about the Opposition’s ability to dislodge entrenched BJP governments. The party had mounted a campaign around allegations involving the chief minister’s family, which were denied, but failed to translate that into electoral gains.

Beyond individual states, the broader implications of the verdict are likely to shape national politics in the coming years. With key Assembly elections scheduled in Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, Goa and Uttarakhand in 2027, Opposition leaders acknowledge the need to reassess their approach. The BJP, buoyed by victories in Assam, West Bengal and Puducherry, has already claimed that the results reveal deep divisions within the INDIA bloc.

Within Opposition circles, there is recognition that maintaining unity will be critical. Leaders argue that the alliance must refine its messaging and coordination to remain a credible counterweight. The results have also revived debate over strategic decisions, including the bloc’s opposition to the Constitution amendment bill on women’s reservation and delimitation, an issue that BJP leaders have framed as politically advantageous.

For the Congress, which leads the alliance, the immediate task is to hold together a coalition that now appears more uncertain than it did just weeks ago. Party leaders have struck a defiant tone since the results fell short of expectations but insisted the party would continue its ideological struggle. “The path of the struggle for democracy and truth against authoritarianism and falsehood is invariably long and arduous,” he said, adding that a detailed review of the results would follow. In the aftermath of the verdict, Rahul Gandhi reached out to Mamata Banerjee and M K Stalin, while also congratulating Vijay on his party’s performance, signalling efforts to keep communication channels open despite the setbacks.

Yet the central dilemma persists. The decline of two of the Opposition’s most assertive regional players has altered the balance within the alliance. For years, parties like the TMC had argued that their ability to defeat the BJP in their states gave them a stronger claim to national leadership. With that argument weakened, the Congress may find greater space to assert itself, but it also faces the burden of delivering results that match its ambitions.

Now, the INDIA bloc will have to confront a defining moment. Whether the alliance can regroup and present a unified front against a resurgent BJP will depend on how it navigates this phase of uncertainty and on who ultimately emerges to guide it forward.



EDITORIAL

END OF REGIONAL ERA?

The steady unravelling of regional political dominance across India is no longer an isolated trend—it is beginning to resemble a structural shift in the country's electoral behaviour. The recent defeats of long-entrenched regional forces, including the All-India Trinamool Congress in West Bengal and the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam in Tamil Nadu, underline a deeper churn. These were not merely electoral losses; they signalled the weakening of political narratives built on regional identity, linguistic pride and sub-national assertion. For decades, such frameworks provided a powerful counterweight to national parties. Today, that balance appears to be tilting decisively.

What makes this moment particularly striking is that the erosion of regional parties is cutting across geography and political histories. From the decline of the Biju Janata Dal in Odisha after a 24-year run, to the shrinking influence of formations like the Aam Aadmi Party and the CPI(M), the pattern is consistent. Even where regional parties survive, they are increasingly on the defensive. Tamil Nadu, once the citadel of Dravidian politics, witnessed a campaign centred on identity that failed to overcome anti-incumbency. In West Bengal, a party that had mastered the idiom of regional resistance found itself unable to sustain its dominance. These outcomes suggest that voters are no longer responding to regional narratives with the same intensity as before.

The roots of this transformation lie partly in the changing nature of political aspiration. The post-1989 era saw the rise of regional parties as instruments of representation for local grievances and cultural identity, especially in a fragmented national political landscape. Coalition governments at the Centre depended on these parties, giving them leverage to negotiate for state-specific interests. That phase, however, has gradually given way to a more centralised political imagination. Since 2014, the consolidation of a strong national leadership and the expansion of a single party's organisational footprint have altered the grammar of elections. Voters are increasingly factoring in national leadership, welfare delivery and perceived governance stability alongside local considerations.

This does not mean that federal concerns have disappeared. On the contrary, opposition parties continue to raise questions about fiscal devolution, the use of central agencies and the implications of delimitation. Yet, these issues have not translated into decisive electoral gains for regional forces. There is a growing disconnect between the political language of federalism and the voters' calculus. Welfare schemes delivered directly to beneficiaries, improvements in infrastructure and the projection of decisive leadership seem to be carrying greater electoral weight. In such a scenario, regional parties find themselves squeezed—they must defend their local relevance while competing with the expansive appeal of national narratives.

However, it would be premature to declare the end of regional politics. India's diversity ensures that local identities, cultural assertions and state-specific issues will continue to matter. The successes of parties like the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha in recent elections, or the continued relevance of regional players in states like Jammu and Kashmir, indicate that the space has not vanished. What has changed is the threshold for success. Regional parties can no longer rely solely on identity-based mobilisation or historical legacy. They must reinvent themselves as vehicles of governance that can match the delivery, communication and organisational strength of national parties.

The larger question, therefore, is not whether regional parties will survive, but how they will adapt. The answer may lie in recalibrating their politics—moving from narrow identity assertions to broader development agendas, strengthening grassroots networks, and building credible leadership that can resonate beyond traditional voter bases. At the same time, national parties must recognise that excessive centralisation carries its own risks. A healthy democracy requires a dynamic interplay between national coherence and regional representation.

The current moment reflects a reconfiguration rather than a replacement. The voter is not abandoning the regional in favour of the national entirely; instead, they are redefining expectations from both. For regional parties, this is a moment of reckoning. For Indian democracy, it is a reminder that political relevance is never permanent—it must be continually earned, not inherited.

ILLNESS TO WELLNESS



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS CHAIRPERSON, ADVISORY COUNCIL, ILLNESS TO WELLNESS FOUNDATION

Hygiene is not a one-day campaign; it is a daily discipline that must be practised consistently at home, workplaces and in public spaces

GROUND REALITY



PRASANNA MISHRA

THE WRITER IS A FORMER SECRETARY TO THE GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

The crisis is not of intent, but of design—where procedure replaces judgment and access becomes exclusion

Clean Hands, Healthier India

World Hand Hygiene Day 2026 is a reminder that hygiene must move beyond awareness into daily action, stronger institutions and shared public responsibility

Each year, World Hand Hygiene Day reminds us that some of the most powerful public health interventions are also the easiest. Observed on 5 May, the day forms part of the World Health Organization's global "Save Lives: Clean Your Hands" campaign, launched in 2009 to keep hand hygiene and infection prevention in healthcare at the centre of public attention and to bring institutions and communities together in support of improvement. In 2026, as the campaign marks 18 years, its theme, "Action saves lives," gives the observance renewed relevance. Awareness alone is no longer enough. Clean hands, safe sanitation, responsible hygiene behaviour and stronger infection prevention systems must become part of everyday life, from hospitals and schools to homes, workplaces, public transport, food establishments and community spaces.

For us at the Illness to Wellness Foundation, this year's theme is an opportunity to place hygiene within the larger framework of preventive healthcare. This belief has already taken practical shape through our sustained awareness activities on handwashing practices in schools, where students are educated on the importance of proper hand hygiene. Through this initiative, over one million students have been reached and sensitised. The activities include practical demonstrations, interactive quizzes, informative messages and innovative videos on handwashing, ensuring that hygiene education is not only instructive, but also engaging and easy to understand. By focusing on children, the Foundation recognises that habits formed early can influence families, classrooms and communities, making schools an important starting point for building a healthier India.

The pandemic years brought hand hygiene into the national conversation, but the challenge now is to ensure that people do not forget the lessons that were learned. India's public health priorities are expanding from treatment to prevention, and hygiene sits at the centre of that transition. Every avoided infection means fewer hospital visits, lower medical expenses, reduced antibiotic use and a lighter burden on families. This is particularly important when antimicrobial resistance is emerging as a serious global concern. When infections spread because of poor hygiene, antibiotics are used more frequently, sometimes unnecessarily, weakening their effectiveness over time.

The healthcare setting remains one of the most critical spaces for hygiene action. Hospitals are meant to heal, yet without rigorous infection prevention and control practices, they can also become sites of



Clean hands prevent infections, reduce hospital visits, lower medical costs and help curb unnecessary antibiotic use

transmission. WHO has noted that out of every 100 patients in acute-care hospitals, seven in high-income countries and 15 in low- and middle-income countries acquire at least one healthcare-associated infection during their hospital stay. It has also observed that hand hygiene improvement programmes can prevent up to 50 percent of avoidable infections acquired during healthcare delivery and generate economic savings averaging 16 times the cost of implementation. These figures remind us that hygiene is a life-saving, cost-saving and system-strengthening public health investment.

India has already built an important foundation through initiatives that link cleanliness, sanitation and health. Swachh Bharat Mission Urban 2.0, backed by an outlay of Rs.1,41,600 crore for 2021–22 to 2025–26, has moved the conversation beyond open defecation to a broader sanitation agenda that includes garbage-free cities, sustainable sanitation, scientific waste processing, used-water management and citizen participation. Building on a mission that covered 4,041 statutory towns in its first phase, SBM-U 2.0 aims to achieve "Garbage Free" status for all cities by 2026. Its emphasis on digital innovation has also helped bring governance and public feedback into the sanitation ecosystem.

In the healthcare sector, the Kayakalp initiative has created a valuable model by recognising and incentivising cleanliness, hygiene, waste management and infection control practices in public healthcare facilities. Public trust in healthcare is shaped not only by doctors and medicines, but also by visible standards of cleanliness, patient safety and dignity. A clean ward, a func-

tional washroom, safe biomedical waste disposal and consistent hand hygiene protocols are not cosmetic improvements. They are core elements of quality care.

What makes the hygiene agenda particularly relevant in 2026 is the emergence of newer innovations that are changing how India can think about cleanliness. Public toilets are increasingly being connected with digital feedback systems, QR-code-based complaint mechanisms and toilet-locator platforms. Waste management is gradually becoming more scientific, with greater focus on segregation, processing and circular use. Hospitals are adopting structured cleanliness audits, infection control committees, colour-coded waste disposal, hand-rub stations, contactless fixtures and hygiene training modules. In some urban areas, mechanised sewer cleaning and technology-supported sanitation services are also helping reduce hazardous manual exposure for sanitation workers. The future of hygiene will depend not only on building infrastructure, but on maintaining it, monitoring it and making citizens active participants in its success.

India can also draw useful lessons from other countries. Singapore's approach to public toilet cleanliness shows the importance of combining infrastructure, monitoring, technology and shared responsibility. Feedback panels, ammonia sensors, cleanliness grading and better toilet design demonstrate that hygiene improves when citizens, cleaners, facility managers and regulators are connected through accountable systems. This is valuable for Indian cities, where the next frontier is not merely constructing facilities, but ensuring that they remain usable, safe and dignified every day.

Japan offers another lesson, this time in civic culture. In many Japanese schools, children participate in cleaning classrooms and shared spaces, turning cleanliness into a lesson in responsibility, humility and respect for common environments. The larger lesson is that hygiene cannot be outsourced entirely. A society becomes cleaner when citizens grow up understanding that public spaces belong to everyone, and therefore must be cared for by everyone.

The global lesson from WHO is equally important. Hand hygiene succeeds when it is embedded into systems, not reduced to occasional messaging. Training, infrastructure, reminders, observation, feedback and leadership support must work together. This is why the 2026 theme, "Action saves lives," is so meaningful. It asks healthcare workers, policymakers, institutions and citizens to move from intention to implementation. A poster may remind people to wash their hands, but a working sink, available soap, alcohol-based hand rub, trained staff, clean toilets and regular monitoring turn that message into real protection.

For citizens, the action agenda begins with simple but consistent practices. Washing hands with soap at critical moments, before eating, after using the toilet, after coughing or sneezing, after handling waste and before caring for the sick, remains one of the most effective everyday habits. Food hygiene, safe drinking water, clean household surfaces, responsible waste disposal and menstrual hygiene must also be understood as part of the same wellness framework. Hygiene is not a one-day campaign. It is a daily discipline.

For institutions, the responsibility is larger. Schools must ensure clean toilets, handwashing facilities and hygiene education. Hospitals must make infection prevention a non-negotiable standard. Workplaces must provide clean washrooms and encourage safe practices. Food businesses must treat hygiene as a matter of public trust. Local bodies must maintain public sanitation with reliability and dignity. Citizens, in turn, must use facilities responsibly and report gaps constructively.

World Hand Hygiene Day 2026, therefore, arrives with a message that is simple yet urgent. Clean hands save lives, but action saves them consistently. I believe that India's journey towards wellness will be strengthened when hygiene becomes part of public policy, institutional culture and personal conduct. The call must be clear. Let hygiene move beyond awareness into everyday action. Because a healthier India will be built through clean hands, clean spaces and shared responsibility.

Views expressed are personal

Dignity Beyond Procedure

Jeetu Munda's haunting act in Keonjhar exposes a deeper governance failure where rules override reality, and dignity is lost in procedural rigidity

In the dense moral universe of the Mahabharata, the encounter between the Yaksha and Yudhishtira is not merely a test of wisdom—it is a test of moral clarity, of the ability to see beyond the immediate and grasp the essential. In a hauntingly real echo of that ancient episode, Jeetu Munda of Dianali Village in Keonjhar district emerged as a modern Yaksha. His question, however, was not posed in words but in an act so stark that it stripped governance of all its pretensions: he carried the exhumed remains of his sister to a bank, demanding recognition, dignity, and access.

The tragedy is not that the system failed to respond—it did, in its characteristic way. Compensation was announced. An inquiry was ordered. A culprit was identified. But like Mohan Majhi in this unfolding drama, the state faltered—not in action, but in understanding. It failed to grasp the depth of the question being asked.

The Question Behind the Act Jeetu Munda's act was not an aberration born of ignorance or emotional excess. It was, in fact, a deeply symbolic indictment of a system that demands procedural perfection from those least equipped to provide it. In a labyrinth of documentation, identity proofs, biometric verifications, and institutional formalities, the poor—especially tribal citizens—are expected to navigate with the precision of trained bureaucrats.

The banker, as it turns out, was not the villain. He was a cog in a rigid machine, bound by rules that leave little room for contextual judgment. The real failure lies in the architecture of governance itself—an architecture that is elaborate,



ubiquitous, and yet curiously inaccessible.

Jeetu's question, then, was simple yet profound: Can a system that cannot recognize my reality claim to serve me?

The Illusion of Presence

Modern governance prides itself on reach. Schemes proliferate. Offices multiply. Digital platforms promise seamless delivery. Yet, as Jeetu's ordeal reveals, presence is not the same as accessibility.

The state is everywhere, and yet it is nowhere when it matters most.

For citizens like Jeetu, the state appears not as a facilitator but as a gatekeeper—demanding compliance with norms that are often alien to their lived realities. The assumption underlying policy design is that citizens are literate, digitally savvy,

and institutionally aware. This assumption collapses in regions like Keonjhar, where socio-economic vulnerabilities intersect with cultural and linguistic barriers.

The Tyranny of Procedure

At the heart of the problem is an over-reliance on procedure as a substitute for judgment. Rules are designed to ensure uniformity and prevent misuse. But when applied without sensitivity, they become instruments of exclusion.

The requirement of documentation—death certificates, identity proofs, linkage with bank accounts—may appear reasonable in abstraction. But in practice, they create insurmountable hurdles for those who live on the margins. When a grieving brother is forced to exhume his sister's remains to

prove her existence, the system has crossed from inefficiency into moral failure.

The inquiry that followed, which reportedly placed blame on the banker, only underscores this failure. It is easier to identify an individual scapegoat than to confront systemic inadequacies. Such responses provide closure without resolution.

The Culture of Superficial Relief

The immediate aftermath of the incident followed a familiar script: financial assistance was announced, assurances were given, and the machinery of governance moved on. This culture of reactive relief—while politically expedient—does little to address underlying issues.

Cash compensation, in such cases, functions as a palliative, not a cure. It soothes public outrage but leaves the structural infirmities intact. The risk is that governance becomes performative—focused on optics rather than outcomes.

Towards a More Humane Governance

If Jeetu Munda's act is to mean anything, it must compel a rethinking of how governance is conceived and delivered.

From Rule-Based to Context-Sensitive Administration

Frontline officials must be empowered to exercise discretion. This requires not just training but a shift in institutional culture—from compliance to compassion.

Simplification of Processes

Documentation requirements must be radically simplified, especially for vulnerable populations. Alternatives such as community verification, local authority certification, and mobile outreach units can bridge the gap between formal systems and informal realities.

Last-Mile Facilitation, Not Just Delivery

The state must move from a model of passive availability to active facilitation. This means deploying trained intermediaries—community workers, Panchayat-level facilitators—who can assist citizens in navigating procedures.

Accountability Beyond Individuals

Inquiries must focus on systemic gaps rather than individual lapses. Accountability frameworks should identify process failures and recommend structural reforms, not merely assign blame.

Embedding Empathy in Governance

Perhaps most importantly, governance must rediscover empathy. This is not a soft virtue but a critical administrative competency. Policies designed without an understanding of ground realities are destined to fail.

The Unanswered Question

In the Mahabharata, Yudhishtira answers the Yaksha's questions with wisdom and humility, earning the restoration of life and order. In Keonjhar, the Yaksha has asked his question—but the answer remains elusive.

Jeetu Munda did not seek charity. He sought recognition—of his sister's existence, of his own dignity, and of his right to access what the state promises. Until governance can respond to that fundamental demand, it will continue to falter, no matter how elaborate its structures or how generous its schemes.

The moment of truth has arrived. The question is whether the state is willing to listen—not to the noise of outrage, but to the quiet, persistent voice of justice that Jeetu Munda has so powerfully invoked.

Views expressed are personal

AMERICA CLAIMS PROGRESS IN REOPENING HORMUZ

US says two merchant vessels have gone through Hormuz

DUBAI: The US military said Monday that two American-flagged merchant ships had successfully transited the Strait of Hormuz after it launched a new initiative to restore traffic. The United Arab Emirates meanwhile issued three missile alerts and authorities said an Iranian drone hit an oil facility.

Iran has effectively controlled the strait since the US and Israel launched the war in late February. Breaking Iran's chokehold would ease global economic concerns and deny Tehran a major source of leverage in talks aimed at ending the war. But US President Donald Trump's latest effort also risks reigniting full-scale fighting as the US and Iran steadily ramp up pressure.

The United Arab Emirates issued its first three missile alerts since a ceasefire reached in early April and accused Iran of targeting an oil tanker. The eastern emirate of Fujairah said an Iranian drone sparked a fire at an oil facility, and a monitoring center operated by the British military said a cargo ship was ablaze off the UAE coast.

An explosion and fire meanwhile broke out aboard a South Korean-operated ship anchored in the strait, though its cause was unknown, the South Korean government said.

In another sign of possible escalation, Iran claimed to have struck a US Navy vessel near the strait. The US denied the claim.

Iran's effective closure of the strait, which runs between Iran and Oman, has caused a spike in worldwide fuel prices and rattled the global economy. The US-led Joint Maritime Information Center is now advising ships to cross the strait in



Oil tankers sit at anchor offshore in the Strait of Hormuz off Bandar Abbas

AP/PTI

Highlights

- » Iran has effectively controlled the strait since the US and Israel launched the war in Feb
- » The US has warned shipping companies they

- could face sanctions for paying Iran for transit of the strait
- » Iran's military command on Monday said ships passing through the strait must coordinate with them

Oman's waters, saying it set up an "enhanced security area."

It was unclear whether shipping companies, and their insurers, will feel comfortable taking the risk given that Iran has fired on ships in the waterway and vowed to keep doing so. Iran has said the new US effort is a violation of the fragile ceasefire that has held for more than three weeks.

The US military's Central Command said the two American-flagged merchant ships were "safely headed on their

journey" after transiting the Strait of Hormuz. It said Navy guided-missile destroyers in the Persian Gulf were helping to restore traffic.

Its statement on X said that US destroyers had also transited the strait. It did not say when the Navy ships arrived or when the merchant vessels departed.

Trump's announcement Sunday that the US would "guide" ships out of the strait warned that Iranian efforts to block them "will, unfortunately,

have to be dealt with forcefully."

He described "Project Freedom" in humanitarian terms, designed to aid stranded seafarers on hundreds of ships that have been stuck in the Persian Gulf since the war began. Crews have described to The Associated Press seeing drones and missiles explode over the waters earlier in the war as their vessels run low on drinking water, food and other supplies.

Iran's state-run IRNA news agency called the effort part of Trump's "delirium."

Iran's military command on Monday said ships passing through the strait must coordinate with them.

"We warn that any foreign military force — especially the aggressive US military — that intends to approach or enter the Strait of Hormuz will be targeted," Maj. Gen. Ali Abdollahi told state broadcaster IRIB.

The disruption of the waterway has squeezed countries in Europe and Asia that depend on Persian Gulf oil and gas, raising prices far beyond the region. The US has warned shipping companies they could face sanctions for paying Iran for transit of the strait. AGENCIES

Rubio plans to visit Vatican amid Trump's clash with Pope

WASHINGTON: Secretary of State Marco Rubio will travel to Rome and Vatican City this week in a bid to ease rising tensions between President Donald Trump and Pope Leo XIV over US policies, particularly the Iran war.

The State Department said Monday that Rubio, a Catholic who has visited Rome and the Vatican at least three times since becoming the Republican president's top diplomat, would be in Italy on Thursday and Friday.

"Secretary Rubio will meet with Holy See leadership to discuss the situation in the Middle East and mutual interests in the Western Hemisphere," the department said. "Meetings with Italian counterparts will be focused on shared security interests and strategic alignment." AGENCIES

3 PEOPLE KILLED IN THE ATTACK

Afghan accuses Pak of cross-border attacks

KABUL: Afghanistan accused Pakistan Monday of carrying out cross-border attacks into its territory, hitting civilian areas and leaving at least three people dead and 14 others wounded, as tension between the two neighbors remained high despite recent peace talks.

Afghan deputy government spokesman Hamdullah Fitrat posted on X that Pakistani attacks had destroyed two schools, two mosques and a health center in the eastern Afghan province of Kunar.

There was no immediate comment from Pakistan on the allegation. Islamabad has repeatedly rejected previous accusations of striking civilian areas in Afghanistan.

Pakistan and Afghanistan had been embroiled in months of deadly fighting that killed hundreds of people since late February, when Afghanistan launched a cross-

European leaders see Trump's troop drawdown from Germany

YEREVAN: European leaders on Monday said that President Donald Trump's snap decision to pull thousands of US troops out of Germany came as a surprise but is a fresh sign that Europe must take care of its own security.

The Pentagon announced last week that it would pull some 5,000 troops out of Germany, but Trump told reporters on Saturday that "we're going to cut way down. And we're cutting a lot further than 5,000."

He offered no reason for the move, which blindsided NATO, but his decision came amid an escalating dispute with German Chancellor Friedrich Merz over the US-Israeli war on Iran, and Trump's anger over European allies' reluctance to get involved in the conflict in the Middle East.

Asked about the American decision, Norwegian Prime Minister Jonas Gahr Store said,



European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen

"I wouldn't exaggerate that because I think we are expecting that Europe is taking more charge of its own security."

"I do not see those figures as dramatic, but I think they should be handled in a harmonious way inside the framework of NATO," he told reporters in Yerevan, Armenia, where European leaders held a summit.

British Prime Minister

Keir Starmer said that "there needs to be a stronger European element in NATO, I have no doubt, about that."

He told his European partners that there is "more tension" in some of their international alliances than there should be, and it is very important that we therefore face up to this.

The European Union's foreign policy chief, Kaja Kallas, said, "There has been talk about withdrawal of US troops for a long time from Europe. But of course, the timing of this announcement comes as a surprise."

"I think it shows that we have to really strengthen the European pillar in NATO," she said.

Asked whether she believes that Trump is trying to punish Merz, who said that the US has been humiliated by Iran in talks to end the war, Kallas said: "I don't see into the head of President Trump, so he has to explain it himself." AGENCIES

Iran drone attack: Fire in Fujairah Oil Industry Zone, 3 Indians injured

DUBAI: Three Indian nationals were injured on Monday after a fire broke out in the Fujairah Petroleum Industries Zone (FOIZ) in the UAE following a drone strike originating from Iran, according to local media reports.

The relevant authorities in the eastern emirate of Fujairah confirmed that a fire has broken out in the FOIZ, resulting from a drone attack coming from Iran, the state-run WAM news agency reported.

Fujairah Civil Defence teams immediately responded to the incident and are continuing efforts to bring the fire under control, it added.

Three Indian nationals sustained moderate injuries after the fire broke out on the FOIZ, the Khaleej Times reported, quoting authorities in Fujairah.

The injured were taken to the hospital for treatment, it added. In a post on X, the

AUTHORITIES IN EASTERN EMIRATE OF FUJAIRAH CONFIRMED THAT A FIRE HAS BROKEN OUT IN THE FOIZ

UAE's Ministry of Defence said that Iran launched four missiles toward various areas across the country.

"Three were successfully engaged over the country's territorial waters, while one fell into the sea," it said.

The ministry urged the public to comply with all public safety procedures when warning messages are issued to the public.

Authorities have urged the public not to circulate rumours and to rely only on official sources for information, Gulf News reported. AGENCIES

States across wildfire-prone US use AI for early detection

The technology is mostly used in high-risk areas

WASHINGTON: On a March afternoon, artificial intelligence detected something resembling smoke on a camera feed from Arizona's Coconino National Forest. Human analysts verified it wasn't a cloud or dust, then alerted the state's forest service and largest electric utility.

One of dozens of AI cameras installed for the utility Arizona Public Service had spotted early signs of what came to be known as the Diamond Fire. Firefighters raced to the scene and contained the blaze before it grew past 7 acres (2.8 hectares).

As record-breaking heat and an abysmal snowpack raise concerns about severe wildfires, states across the fire-prone West are adding AI to their wildfire detection toolbox, banking on the technology to help save lives and property.

Arizona Public Service has nearly 40 active AI smoke-detection cameras and plans to have 71 by summer's end, and the state's fire agency has deployed seven of its own. Another utility, Xcel Energy in Colorado, has installed 126 and aims to have cameras in seven of the eight states it serves by year's end.

"Earlier detection means we can launch aircraft and person-



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

Key Points

- » One of dozens of AI cameras installed for the utility Arizona Public Service
- » With the help of AI, firefighters race to the scene and contain the blaze before it grew past 7 acres
- » AI that's being run on the cameras is actually beating 911 calls

ALERTCalifornia is a network of some 1,240 AI-enabled cameras across the Golden State that work similar to the system in Arizona. Human intervention keeps the risk of false positives low and trains the technology to become more accurate, said Neal Driscoll, geology and geophysics professor at the University of California, San Diego, and founder of ALERTCalifornia.

"The AI that's being run on the cameras is actually beating 911 calls," he said.

In Arizona, California and beyond, the technology is mostly used in high-risk areas that are sparsely populated, rural or remote, where a blaze might not be quickly spotted by human eyes. AGENCIES

Guyana, Venezuela return to UN court to settle dispute over border region

THE HAGUE: Guyana told the United Nations' highest court on Monday that 70 per cent of its territory is at stake in a historic border dispute with Venezuela over a swath of jungle that is rich in resources.

The International Court of Justice is holding a week of hearings between the South American neighbours claiming ownership of the Essequ-

ibo region, which is rich in gold, diamonds, timber and other natural resources and is located close to massive offshore oil deposits.

"This has been a blight on our existence as a sovereign state from the very beginning," Guyana Foreign Minister Hugh Hilton Todd told judges at the Great Hall of Justice in The Hague. AGENCIES

PUBLIC NOTICE

ICICI Bank

Regd. Office: ICICI Bank Limited, Landmark, Race Course Circle, Vadodara- 390007

Corporate Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra- Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai- 400051

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Ltd Plot No. 7, Community Centre S.D. Tower, Sector 8, Rohini, New Delhi, 110085

A notice is hereby given that the following borrower/s have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest of the loans facility obtained by them from the Bank and the loans have been classified as Non Performing Assets (NPA). The notice were issued to them under Section 13 (2) of Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act-2002 on their last known addresses as provided to the bank by them, that in addition thereto for the purposes of information of the said borrowers enumerated below, the said borrowers are being informed by way of this public notice.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ (Loan Account Number) & Address	Description of Secured Asset to be enforced	Date of Notice sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice	NPA Date
1.	LAPUP00042608121/ Alam Gir/ Mid Alam Gir Naman Manjil, Iqbal Nagar Madhopara, Purnia, Delhi-854301	T (O)/ Redi-GO/ BR11AT2258	23-12-2025 Rs. 19,78,439,00/-	15-Jul-2025

The above borrower/s and/or their guarantors (where ever applicable) are advised to make the payments of outstanding within period of 60 days from the date of issuance of notice U/s 13 (2), failing which further steps will be taken after expiry of 60 days from the date of issuance of notice U/s 13 (2) as per the provisions of Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

Date: May 05, 2026
Place: Delhi/Ncr

Sincerely, Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

e-Procurement Cell
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER,
BUILDING CONSTRUCTION DEPARTMENT,BUILDING DIVISION GUMLA

Short Notice Tender Inviting
Tender Reference No.-01BCD/GUMLA/2026-27

क्र.सं.	कार्य का नाम	प्रारम्भित राशि	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
I	Proposed Construction of Weigh Bridge and Operator Room with 1000 MT Godown at Ghaghra Gumla Jharkhand.	2,96,29,500.00	11 मा
i	वेबसाइट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि		11.05.2026
ii	बिड प्रारित के लिए अंतिम तिथि / समय	18.05.2026 को अपरान्ह 3.00 बजे।	
iii	निविदा खोलने की तिथि / समय	19.05.2026 को सुबह 11.00 बजे।	
iv	निविदा प्रकाशित करने वाले कार्यालय का नाम एवं पता	Office of the Executive Engineer,Building Construction Department,Building Division, Gumla	
v	प्रोग्रेसीट पदाधिकारी का सम्पर्क संख्या	8709489994	
vi	ई-प्रोक्वोरमेंट सेल का हेल्पलाईन संख्या	9990708350	

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Central Bank of India

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OF SECURITISATION ACT 2002

OLD RAJAPURI BRANCH, DWARKA, NEW DELHI-110059

Demand Notice Under Section 13(2) of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest (SARFAESI) Act, 2002 to the Borrower/s and Guarantor/s.

This Demand Notice is hereby given under section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 hereinafter calling upon the under mentioned Borrowers / Guarantors to repay, the Amounts outstanding for the Credit Facilities granted to them / on their Guarantee, within 60 days from the date of this Notice. If you fail to repay to the Bank the below mentioned amount with further interest and incidental expenses, costs etc. in terms of this notice u/s 13(2) of the Act, the Bank will exercise all or any of the rights detailed under Sub-Section (4) of Section 13 and under other applicable provisions of the said Act. You are also put on notice that in terms of sub-section 4 of Section 13 you shall not transfer by sale, lease or otherwise the said secured assets detailed below of this notice without obtaining written consent of the Bank. The details of the account and Secured Assets along with Amount Outstanding is given below:-

SCHEDULE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY & OTHER DETAILS

Name & Address of Borrower and Guarantor	Description of the Secured Asset	Date & Amount of 13(2) Notice
BORROWER: MRS. SAMPUJITA MISHRA W/O MR. ANIL KUMAR MISHRA CO-BORROWER: MR. ANIL KUMAR MISHRA S/O SH. RADHEY SHYAM MISHRA Address 1: RZ-G-30/B-4, 3rd Floor, Raj Nagar-II, Palam Colony, New Delhi-110077. GUARANTOR: MANMATH MANI TRIPATHI S/O SH. MADAN TRIPATHI Address 1: RZ-H - 757, 2nd Floor, Gali No.14, Raj Nagar-II, Palam Colony, New Delhi-110045. Address 2: 156, Khoramkhas, Tehsil Roodrapur, Distt. - Deoria (U.P.)-274204.	[Detailed description of the secured Asset/Mortgaged Property/ Hypothecated Goods] IMMOVABLE ASSET: Property Bearing No. RZ-G-30/B-4, Third Floor without Roof Rights, Area Measuring 70 Sq.Yds. i.e. 58.53 Sq.Mtrs., Old Portion of Plot No.5, out of Total Area Measuring 205 Sq.Yds. out of Khasra No.55/18 & 55/19 situated in the area of Vill.-Palam, Delhi Colony known as Raj Nagar-II, Palam Colony, New Delhi-110077, the name of Mrs. Sampujita Mishra W/o Mr. Anil Kumar Mishra & Mr. Anil Kumar Mishra S/o Sh. Radhey Shyam Mishra. Boundries are: East: Plot No.1 West: Plot No.6 North: Gali 10 Ft South : Road 15 Ft	Date of 13(2) Notice: 21/04/2026 NPA : 20/04/2026 Rs.14,80,235.74 (Rupees Fourteen Lakh Eighty Thousand Two Hundred Thirty Five and Seventy Four Paise Only) with further interest at the applicable rate/s of interest mentioned in the Schedule A from the date of notice 21/04/2026 till the date of full and final payment along with incidental expenses, charges and costs recoverable from you as per terms of contract and/or as per law, within sixty days from the date of this notice.

YOUR ATTENTION IS DRAWN TO THE PROVISIONS OF SECTION 13(8) OF THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002 IN RESPECT OF TIME AVAILABLE TO YOU TO REDEM THE SECURED ASSETS.

DATE: 04.05.2026
PLACE: NEW DELHI

Sd/- Authorised Officer,
Central Bank of India

DASTI PROCESS FOR PUBLICATION
In the Court of SH. ANUJ AGRAWAL, ASJ - 03
ROOM NO.313, THIRD FLOOR, SAKET COURTS, NEW DELHI, SOUTH EAST DELHI

NOTICE

Date of Order: 23.01.2026
CR REV 234/2025
Next Date of Hearing: 20.05.2026
UCO BANK **Plaintiff**

VS

R. K. CHAWLA **Defendant**

To,
R. K. CHAWLA S/O HARBANS LAL CHAWLA
R/O B-1004, GF Sector-1, Vaishali, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201010.
Also At: M 2 501, A Block, Classic Residency, Raj Nagar Extension, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201017.
Also At: F-416, Sector 3, Vaishali Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201010. Mobile No.: 7827156754

WHEREAS **CR REV 234/2025** application has been made before me and you are hereby informed through this notice dated 07.02.2026, you are hereby required to appear in person or by pleader.

SEAL OF COURT Additional Sessions Judge-03 (South East) Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Corrigendum Notice

Tender No. 365135 Dated: 02.05.2026

Corrigendum Details	Corrigendum Publish Date
Corrigendum No 1	02.05.2026, 10:56

Tender Details Closing Date/Time 03.06.2026, 15:00
Tender No 365135 (Open Tender)
Name of Work: Comprehensive Maintenance Contract of Vande Bharat Express Trainset

Item Modified NIT Header

Field Name	Existing Value	Modified Value
Pre-Bid query Date Time	04.05.2026, 11:00	11.05.2026, 11:00

1479/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

JHARIA REHABILITATION AND DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY, DHANBAD
e-Procurement Notice
Tender Reference No: JRDA/CIVIL/26-27/03/35
Date: 29.04.2026

1.	Name of Work	Providing and Laying PCC in back and middle side of blocks at Phase – II & Phase -III, Belgaria, Township Dhanbad
2.	Estimated Cost	Rs. 3,93,27,023.00
3.	EMD	Rs. 3,93,300.00
4.	Tender Document Cost	Rs. 10,000.00
5.	Time of Completion	08 months
6.	Date/Time from which bid is available for online bidding	05.05.2026 at 03:00 PM
7.	Last Date/Time for on-line submission of bids	26.05.2026 at 05:00 PM
8.	Date and Time of Bid Opening	28.05.2026 at 11:30 AM
9.	Name and Address of Officer inviting tender	Head of Department (Civil), JRDA, Dhanbad Hatia More, Golf Ground Road, Hirapur, Dhanbad - 826001 Jharkhand, India Email: infojrda.dhn@gmail.com

Note : 1. Only e-tenders will be accepted.
2. Further details can be seen on website – https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in

Head of Department (Civil), JRDA, Dhanbad

PR 378967 Rural Development (26-27).D

millenniumpost
CLASSIFIEDS
CHANGE OF NAME

I hitherto known as
DEEPAK MANDAL S/O
PHOOLCHAND R/O
rehayakpur, molanpur, VTC:
Sagri District Azamgarh,
State: Uttar Pradesh Pin
Code: 276137, have
changed my name and
shall hereafter be known as
SHIVANAND.

NCLAT dismisses Vedanta’s plea against Adani Group’s bid for JAL

The NCLAT did not find merit in the issues raised by Vedanta

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A company law appeals court on Monday rejected a challenge by mining billionaire Anil Agarwal's Vedanta Ltd to the winning bid by Gautam Adani's group for bankrupt real estate firm Jaiprakash Associates Ltd (JAL), whose assets include India's only Formula One circuit.

The National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) did not find merit in the issues raised by Vedanta and dismissed its two petitions.

A Bench comprising Chairperson Justice (retired) Ashok Bhushan and Technical Member Barun Mitra held that the Committee of Creditors (CoC) were right in preferring Adani Group's Rs 14,535 crore bid over Vedanta's resolution plan for JAL. That decision was approved by the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT), against which Vedanta went into an appeal in NCLAT.

"No grounds have been made out by the appellant (Vedanta) to interfere with the decision of the adjudicating Authority (NCLT)," NCLAT order said. "There is no merit in the appeal. Both appeals are dismissed. There shall be no orders to pass."

NCLAT said the decision of the Committee of Creditors was



NCLAT held that the Committee of Creditors were right in preferring Adani Group's Rs 14,535 crore bid over Vedanta's resolution plan for JAL

based on "overall consideration of the respective resolution plan and was taken in its commercial wisdom." JAL was admitted for insolvency proceedings in June 2024 after it failed to pay bank dues exceeding Rs 57,000 crore.

The resolution process drew 28 expressions of interest, with six final bidders including Vedanta, Adani Enterprises and others. Adani and Vedanta emerged as frontrunners, with Adani's proposal scoring higher on upfront recovery and overall value.

The CoC approved Adani's plan in November 2025 with

Highlights

- » That decision was approved by NCLT, against which Vedanta went into an appeal in NCLAT
- » NCLAT said the decision of the CoC was based on 'overall consideration of respective resolution plan and was taken in its commercial wisdom'
- » Monday's ruling clears the way for Adani's takeover of JAL unless Vedanta challenges it in the Supreme Court

a 93.81 per cent vote. Vedanta later submitted a revised offer, valued at Rs 16,070 crore, but creditors declined to consider it, citing rules barring post-deadline changes.

Vedanta argued the process lacked transparency and that its revised bid offered superior value. Creditors countered that the revised proposal was submitted only after Vedanta became aware it was trailing the winning bid.

The appellate tribunal had earlier declined to stay implementation of Adani's plan, a decision subsequently upheld

by the Supreme Court, which directed an expedited hearing while requiring key implementation decisions to receive tribunal approval. Monday's ruling clears the way for Adani's takeover of JAL unless Vedanta challenges it in the Supreme Court.

In its order, NCLAT also said there has been "no material irregularity committed by Resolution Professional while conducting the plan resolution process." NCLAT also dismissed Vedanta's plea, where it had questioned the evaluation metrics adopted and had said its bid was Rs 3,400 crore higher in gross value terms and roughly Rs 500 crore more in net present value compared to the Adani Group's bid.

Rejecting this, NCLAT said "decision of CoC not approving the resolution plan of the appellant with a higher plan value of Rs 3,400 crores and NPV of Rs 500 crore as compared to plan of respondent No 3 (Adani) cannot be said to be arbitrary or perverse."

On March 17, the NCLT, Allahabad bench, approved Adani Enterprises Ltd's Rs 14,535-crore bid to acquire JAL through the insolvency process. This was challenged by Vedanta before the appellate tribunal NCLAT.

On April 23, the insolvency appellate tribunal had

concluded its hearing after hearing the petitioner Vedanta and respondents, including the Resolution Professional, Committee of Creditors (CoC) and Adani Enterprises.

Vedanta has questioned the evaluation metrics adopted by lenders of JAL, which had selected the lower bid of Rs 3,400 crore from Adani Enterprises for the debt-ridden company and questioned the commercial wisdom of CoC.

Earlier, on March 24, NCLAT declined any interim stay over the Vedanta Group's plea against the order passed by the NCLT approving Rs 14,535-crore bid by the Adani Group for acquiring JAL. However, it had also said the plan would be subject to the outcome of the appeals filed by the Anil Agarwal-led Vedanta Group.

This interim order by NCLAT was challenged before the Supreme Court, which also declined to grant a stay. However, the apex court had directed that if the monitoring committee planned to take any major policy decision, it should first obtain the Tribunal's sanction.

Adani Enterprises had outbid Vedanta and Dalmia Bharat to win the bid for JAL. Adani got the maximum 89 per cent votes from creditors, followed by Dalmia Cement (Bharat), and Vedanta Group.

No financial support planned for retailers' fuel & ATF losses

Indian Oil Corp, Bharat Petroleum and HPCL are incurring substantial losses on sale of petrol and diesel

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government has no plans to extend financial support to state-owned fuel retailers for the losses they are incurring on selling petrol, diesel and aviation turbine fuel (ATF) below cost, an official said on Monday.

Indian Oil Corporation (IOC), Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL) and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd (HPCL) are incurring substantial losses on sale of petrol and diesel after they extended a four-year freeze on revision in retail rates despite input crude oil prices shooting up since the start of West Asia conflict over two months back. They have also, for the first time in more than two decades, begun posting losses on jet fuel (ATF) since last month, as they passed on only a part of the desired increase in prices needed to bring rates at par with cost.

"There is no proposal before the government to support oil marketing companies (for their losses)," said Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary in the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.

While ATF prices for domestic airlines last month increased by 25 per cent - a fourth of the desired increase - there was no change in rates this month, even though the prices for foreign airlines were hiked by over 5 per cent. Simi-



larly, despite under-recoveries of Rs 25-28 a litre, there has been no increase in petrol and diesel prices.

Domestic LPG prices were hiked by Rs 60 per 14.2-kg cylinder on March 7, but that was not enough to cover all the increased cost, and oil companies are booking under-recoveries or losses. The government has, in the past, covered for the under-recoveries on LPG through budgetary subsidy support.

Sharma said there is no increase in retail prices of petrol and diesel, as well as domestic LPG, even though supplies have been disrupted due to the war in West Asia. Only rates of bulk or industrial diesel, as also commercial LPG - the one used by hotels and restaurants - have been increased.

The bulk diesel and commercial LPG make up for only 10 per cent of the fuel, she said. "Every effort has been made to protect the consumers (by not raising retail prices). Consumer interest has been kept in mind

when deciding on the revision," she said.

At the last monthly revision in rates on May 1, the aviation turbine fuel (ATF) price for international airlines was hiked by \$76.55 per kilolitre, or 5.33 per cent, to \$1,511.86 per kl. This came on top of a more than doubling of prices for them on April 1 to \$1,435.31 per kl.

Alongside, prices of commercial LPG - the one used in hotels and restaurants - were hiked by Rs 993 to a record high of Rs 3,071.50 per 19-kg cylinder. The rates for 5-kg FTL or market-priced LPG cylinders were hiked from Rs 549 to Rs 810.50 per bottle.

The 5-kg FTL cylinder now costs just a shade lower than the Rs 913 rate for a 14.2-kg cylinder used in household kitchens (called domestic LPG).

Also, prices of bulk diesel, used by industrial users like telecom signal towers, were increased from about Rs 137 per litre to over Rs 149 a litre. These rates compare to the Rs 87.62 a litre price of diesel available at petrol pumps.

The ATF for domestic airlines will continue to be priced at Rs 1,04,927.18 per kl as state-owned oil companies have decided to absorb the rise in global fuel prices to protect airlines and consumers.

Sharma said the actions of oil marketing companies have been to check inflation.

RBI allocates portfolios among four deputy guvs



MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank announced portfolios for deputy governors, including Rohit Jain, who assumed charge on Monday.

Senior most Deputy Governor Swaminathan Janakiraman will look after 11 departments, including of supervision, legal, DICGC, and inspection, the RBI said in a statement.

Poonam Gupta has been assigned six portfolios, including the key monetary policy department.

Deputy Governor Shirish Chandra Murmu will look after five departments, including regulation and enforcement.

Ten portfolios have been allocated to the new Deputy Governor, Rohit Jain. Among others he will look after fintech department, foreign exchange department, and information technology department.

Jain replaced T Rabi Sankar, whose extended tenure ended on Saturday.

Coordination will be looked after by Janakiraman, the RBI said. According to the RBI Act, 1934, the central bank should have four deputy governors: two from within the ranks, one commercial banker, and an economist to head the monetary policy department. PTI

UPI achieves 22.35 bn transactions in April: Dept of Financial Services

NEW DELHI: About 22.35 billion transaction were carried out through the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) in April, Department of Financial Services said on Monday.

In volume terms, UPI transactions grew 25 per cent in April 2026 over the April 2025 when it was 17.89 billion. The UPI transactions had touched a record high of 22.64 billion in volume terms in March, up from 20.39 billion recorded in February.

"UPI achieves 22.35 Bn transaction count in April'26," Department of Financial Services said in a post on X.

UPI combines the ease of use with strong security while following the RBI's two-factor authentication rule. This first factor is the mobile number linked to the user's bank



In volume terms, UPI transactions grew 25 per cent in April 2026 over the April 2025 when it was 17.89 billion

and the second is the UPI PIN, making transactions quick and safe from unauthorised access.

Today, UPI accounts for

about 85 per cent of all digital transactions in India. Its impact goes beyond national borders, powering nearly 50 per cent of global real-time digital payments.

UPI is already live in eight countries, including the UAE, Singapore, Bhutan, Nepal, Sri Lanka, France, Mauritius, and Qatar. This allows Indians travelling or living there to pay seamlessly without the usual hassles of foreign transactions.

NPCL, an initiative of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and the Indian Banks' Association, is an umbrella organisation for operating retail payments and settlement systems in India (IBA).

It runs the UPI used for real-time payments between peers or at merchants' end while making purchases. PTI

Ambuja Cements Q4 PAT rises to ₹1,857.43 cr

NEW DELHI: The Adani Group firm Ambuja Cements Ltd on Monday reported a 37.43 per cent increase in its profit after tax to Rs 1,857.43 crore in the March quarter of 2025-26 compared to the year-ago period. It had reported a profit after tax (PAT) of Rs 1,351.46 crore in the January-March quarter of the last fiscal, according to a regulatory filing from Ambuja Cements Ltd (ACL).

ACL's consolidated revenue from operations was at Rs 10,891.68 crore, up 10 per cent in the March quarter of FY26 compared to Rs 9,894.41 crore in the corresponding period last fiscal. Total expenses were at Rs 10,525.09 crore, up 19.3 per cent in Q4 of FY26.

Its revenue from cement was at Rs 10,417.69 crore, up 8.6 per

ACL's consolidated revenue from operations was at Rs 10,891.68 crore, up 10 per cent in the March quarter of FY26

cent during the quarter. Ready Mix Concrete contributed Rs 581.95 crore, up 36.54 per cent over the same period of FY25.

Total consolidated sales volume of ACL, the second-largest cement manufacturer of the country, stood at 19.9 million tonnes (MT) during the quarter, up 9.34 per cent. In the March quarter, the Adani Group firm, which has in past made acquisitions to expand its operating capacity, reported "highest ever quarterly revenue" along with "highest ever sales volume".

Its total consolidated income, which includes other income as well, was up 5.64 per cent to Rs 11,149.36 crore. It was at Rs 10,553.81 crore in the corresponding March quarter of FY25.

Commenting on the results, ACL Whole Time Director & CEO Vinod Bahety said, "Volumes grew well ahead of the industry, followed by improved realisations driven by a higher share of trade & premium products, and better utilisation of the existing assets."

The consolidated results of Ambuja Cements include the financial performance of its step-down firm ACC Ltd, in

which it owns around 51 per cent stake along with Orient Cements and others.

On a standalone basis, which includes only ACL's performance, in the March quarter, its revenue from operations was up 5.51 per cent to Rs 6,972.21 crore, and its PAT was up twofold to Rs 1,643.66 crore.

In the entire FY26, ACL reported a profit of Rs 5,637.08 crore, up 6.47 per cent. Total consolidated income rose 5.64 per cent to Rs 41,490.02 crore during the financial year ended March 2026.

The consolidated financial results of ACL for the June quarter are not comparable due to the Adani group's acquisition of several companies through ACL and the amalgamation of Adani Cementation. PTI

NEW DELHI: India's cooking gas LPG consumption fell by a steep 16 per cent in April as supply disruptions linked to the West Asia conflict hit availability for both household kitchens and commercial users, according to latest official data.

LPG consumption stood at 2.2 million tonnes in April, 16.16 per cent lower than 2.62 million tonnes consumed in the same period last year. The consumption was 10.5 per cent lower than the 2.45 million tonnes of LPG sales in April 2024.

It was also down month-on-month, lower than the 2.379 million tonnes of consumption in March, according to data from the Oil Ministry's Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell (PPAC).

India imports about 60 per cent of its LPG requirements, much of it via the Strait of Hormuz, which was effectively shut



following US and Israeli strikes on Iran and Tehran's retaliation.

With supplies from Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates disrupted, the government cut LPG supplies to commercial establishments like hotels and industries to safeguard household cooking gas availability.

Also, supplies to households were regulated by increasing

the gap between two refills.

According to PPAC, the decline in LPG consumption in April was lower than the 12.8 per cent year-on-year fall in March.

LPG consumption had grown at a steady pace in recent years, driven by government efforts to replace firewood and other polluting fuels with cleaner alternatives.

With the war leading to airspace closure in many Gulf countries and suspension of flights, jet fuel or ATF consumption fell 1.37 per cent to 761,000 tonnes in April when compared to the previous year. It was also down month-on-month from 807,000 tonnes of sales in March.

Other than the two war-impacted fuels, diesel sales also moderated with just a 0.25 per cent rise to 8.282 million tonnes. In March, diesel sales had risen 8.1 per cent to 8.727 million tonnes.

Petrol sales were up 6.36 per cent to 3.67 million tonnes in April. The growth was lower than the 7.6 per cent rise in March to 3.78 million tonnes.

Consumption of diesel was 4.5 per cent higher than 7.925 million tonnes in April 2024. Petrol sales were 11.7 per cent higher than 3.825 million tonnes in April 2024. PTI

Net direct tax collection rises 5% to ₹23.40 lakh cr in FY2025-26

NEW DELHI: Government's net direct tax collections grew 5.12 per cent to over Rs 23.40 lakh crore in 2025-26, but missed the revised target set for FY26. In the revised estimates (RE) for FY26, the government lowered the direct tax collection target to Rs 24.21 lakh crore. The original budget estimate was set at Rs 25.20 lakh crore.

The government subdued direct tax collection in FY26 follows the income tax cuts that were announced in the 2025-26 budget on February 1, 2025.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman hiked the income tax rebate to Rs 12 lakh effective April 1, 2025, from Rs 7 lakh earlier. She also brought

in across-the-board changes in tax rates and slabs and hiked the standard deduction to Rs 75,000. The move was aimed at leaving more money in the hands of taxpayers to boost demand in the economy.

The RE includes corporate tax collection of Rs 11.09 lakh crore and income tax (including STT) of Rs 13.12 lakh crore. The net corporate tax mop-up in FY26 grew 11.4 per cent to Rs 10.99 lakh crore. Non-corporate tax collection was flat at Rs 11.83 lakh crore.

Non-corporate tax includes taxes paid by individuals, Hindu Undivided Families, firms, associations of persons, bodies of individuals, local authorities,

and artificial juridical persons. The securities transaction tax (STT) collection was up 7.9 per cent to Rs 57,522 crore, according to the data released by the CBDT.

Net direct tax collection (including corporate and non-corporate tax) came in at Rs 23.40 lakh crore in FY26, registering a 5.12 per cent growth over Rs 22.26 lakh crore collected in FY25.

Refund issuance dipped 1.09 per cent year-on-year to Rs 4.71 lakh crore in 2025-26.

Gross direct tax collection during the recently concluded fiscal stood at about Rs 28.12 lakh crore, up 4.03 per cent from the 2024-25 fiscal. PTI

India looks to expand LNG storage capacity as supplies from Qatar stall

Since the start of the West Asia conflict, supplies from Qatar and the UAE, which accounted for about 40 per cent of all imports, have been affected

NEW DELHI: India is looking to expand LNG storage capacity as supply disruptions due to the conflict in West Asia and rising geopolitical risks highlight the need for greater energy security, the chief executive of the country's largest gas importer, Petronet LNG, said on Monday.

India imports about half of its natural gas requirement, which is used to generate electricity, make fertiliser, convert into CNG to run automobiles, piped to household kitchens for cooking and used as feedstock in a variety of industries. This gas is imported in its liquid

form, called LNG, in ships from countries like Qatar and the US.

Since the start of the West Asia conflict, supplies from Qatar and the UAE, which accounted for about 40 per cent of all imports, have been affected, sending New Delhi scrambling for alternative sources.

Petronet LNG Ltd, India's largest liquefied natural gas (LNG) importer, plans to expand storage capacity by building new LNG storage tanks across multiple terminals, CEO A K Singh said at a media call announcing fourth quarter and

FY26 earnings.

The company, he said, will construct two tanks at Gopalpur in Odisha, add one at Kochi in Kerala and pursue additional storage at Dahej in Gujarat, with projects expected to take about three years.

In all, seven tanks are on the drawing board, which are in addition to optimal strategic LNG reserves being evaluated at a national level to manage future crises.

Additional tankages mean more gas can be stored, which can be used to maintain normal supplies in the event of import

CLOSER LOOK

- » Petronet LNG Ltd will construct two tanks at Gopalpur in Odisha, add one at Kochi in Kerala and pursue additional storage at Dahej in Gujarat, with projects expected to take about three years, CEO A K Singh said
- » Singh said Petronet has 10 out of country's 23 LNG tanks which inFY26 handled 26.5 mn tonnes of imported fuel

disruptions.

Singh said Petronet has 10 out of the country's 23 LNG tanks which in 2025-26 handled 26.5 million tonnes of imported fuel.

It has eight tanks at 22.5 mil-

lion tonnes a year, Dahej import facility, and two at 5 million tonnes a year, Kochi terminal.

"We have a very good buffer but supply and drawal should synchronise. We have sufficient tanks for operational reasons

but not for emergencies like war," he said. Petronet has two long-term LNG import contracts - a 7.5 million tonnes a year deal with Qatar and a 1.42 million tonnes a year contract with ExxonMobil.

LNG shipments from the Ras Laffan facility in Qatar have been halted since March 2 after QatarEnergy declared force majeure amid the West Asia conflict, he said, adding no cargoes arrived in March or April, with May also expected to be affected, and June supply is uncertain. The supply disruptions led to cuts being imposed

on several industrial users in order to protect supplies to priority sectors like household kitchens and CNG for transport.

Petronet's one vessel, Disha, was loaded with LNG but got stranded after movement through the Strait of Hormuz was effectively halted following the West Asia conflict, he said, adding Qatar has told Petronet it will resume supplies once the regional situation normalises.

Asked if Qatar has specified any timeframe for resumption of supplies, he said resumption depends on normalisation of the situation and that opera-

tions will restart once conditions improve.

The conflict led to a surge in spot or current market LNG prices to about \$24-25 per million British thermal unit during the disruption before easing to around \$16, he said, adding that demand in India remains highly price-sensitive and requires competitive pricing to sustain growth. Asked if Petronet has changed its long-term procurement strategy after the West Asian conflict, Singh said the company "is not advocating more long-term contracts today and will watch prices. PTI

India’s manufacturing growth sees mild recovery in April: PMI

Meanwhile, new export orders expanded sharply at the start of the first fiscal quarter, with the pace of growth reaching a 7-month high

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India’s manufacturing sector activity witnessed mild recoveries in growth of new business intakes and production, but rates of increase were the second-weakest in nearly four years.

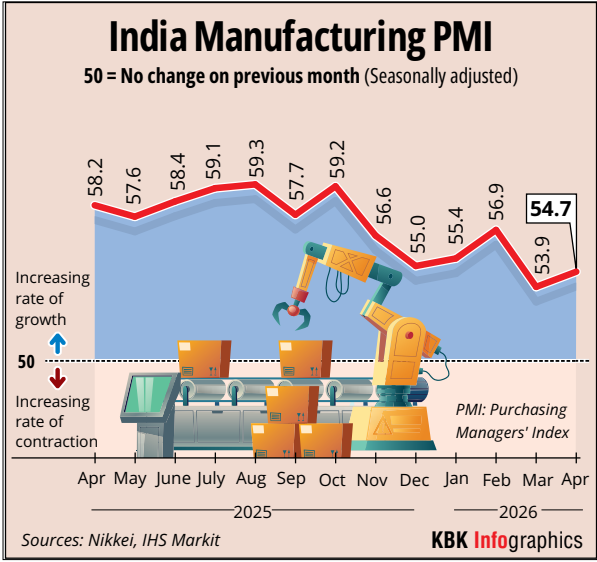
The seasonally adjusted HSBC India Manufacturing Purchasing Managers’ Index rose from 53.9 in March to 54.7 in April, signalled the second-slowest improvement in overall operating conditions in close to four years.

HSBC India Manufacturing Purchasing Managers’ Index (PMI) is a gauge of overall conditions derived from measures of new orders, output, employment, supplier delivery times and stocks of purchases.

In the PMI parlance, a print above 50 means expansion, while a score below 50 denotes contraction.

The two largest sub-components of the PMI, new orders and output, rose since March but trailed readings seen in at least three-and-a-half years.

“India’s manufacturing PMI rose to 54.7 in April, up from 53.9 in March, but still marking the second-slowest improvement in operating conditions in



Highlights

» In the PMI parlance, a print above 50 means expansion, while a score below 50 denotes contraction

» ‘Spillovers from Middle East conflict are becoming more evident, particularly through inflation’

» ‘Input costs increased at the fastest pace since August 2022, and output prices rose at the quickest rate in six months’

Amid reports of higher prices for aluminium, chemicals, electrical components, fuel, leather, petroleum products and rubber, average cost burdens rose further in April. Panellists often attributed hikes to the Middle East war.

The overall rate of inflation climbed to its highest in August 2022. Subsequently, goods producers lifted their fees to the greatest extent in six months, the survey noted.

In terms of employment, despite only a marginal increase in outstanding business volumes, manufacturers recruited additional workers at the start of the first fiscal quarter. Moreover, the rate of job creation was marked and the strongest in ten months.

Indian manufacturers remained optimistic towards growth prospects. However, the overall level of positive sentiment slipped since March. Confidence was pinned on hopes that marketing efforts would bear fruit and that pending projects would be approved.

The HSBC India Manufacturing PMI is compiled by S&P Global from responses to questionnaires sent to purchasing managers in a panel of around 400 manufacturers.

ing a 7-month high. Firms noted better demand from clients in several countries, including Australia, France, Japan, Kenya, mainland China, Saudi Arabia, the UAE and the UK.

On the price front, companies continued to indicate that the war in the Middle East exerted upward pressure on inflation. Input costs and output charges rose at the quickest rates in 44 and six months respectively.

Fertiliser subsidy bill set to exceed budget estimate of ₹1.71 lakh crore

NEW DELHI: The government’s fertiliser subsidy bill for the 2026-27 fiscal is expected to exceed the budgetary allocation of Rs 1.71 lakh crore, with rising costs of imported urea and other fertilisers driven by the ongoing West Asia crisis, a senior ministry official said Monday.

“We know that the costs have risen. Cost of both urea and other fertilisers showing an upward trend... There will surely be an increase, but as of now, cannot say,” Aparna S Sharma, Additional Secretary in the Department of Fertilisers, said at an inter-ministerial briefing on developments in West Asia.

Despite the supply chain disruptions triggered by the West Asia crisis, Sharma said fertiliser availability remains “strong and stable” for the kharif 2026 season. Domestic produc-

tion for March-April stood at 67.76 lakh tonnes — comprising urea (40.72 lakh tonnes), Di ammonium Phosphate (5.39 lakh tonnes), NPK (13.65 lakh tonnes) and SSP (8 lakh tonnes) — supplemented by imports of 17 lakh tonnes.

The imports were managed through coordinated efforts involving the ministries of ports and external affairs. For May, the department has set a domestic production target of 22 lakh tonnes of urea, 4 lakh tonnes of DAP and 8 lakh tonnes of NPK. Some urea plants that had temporarily shut down are set to resume operations, with gas supply already secured, she said.

A global tender for urea imports has been processed, with supplies expected in May-June. A separate global tender for 19 lakh tonnes of NPK fertilisers has also been floated to

meet peak demand.

The Department of Agriculture has assessed the fertiliser requirement for kharif 2026 at 390.54 lakh tonnes. Against this, states have already stocked 195.71 lakh tonnes — nearly 50 per cent of the requirement — reflecting what officials described as “improved planning and advanced stocking”.

State-wise demand has been mapped based on the agriculture ministry’s assessment, with stocking and advance planning already undertaken. Beyond central-level stocking, redistribution within districts remains the responsibility of state governments.

“We are having regular meetings with states. As the season approaches, a 24x7 contingency cell will be set up to tackle redistribution issues,” Sharma said. PTI

Bharat ki Soch: Amitabh Kant to lead dialogue on theme of decolonisation for Viksit Bharat

NEW DELHI: Bharat Ki Soch will host an upcoming session of its flagship Mantrana series, bringing together voices to deliberate on the theme of decolonisation as a pathway towards building a Viksit Bharat.

The session is positioned within the broader national discourse on India’s journey towards 2047, focusing on the need to move beyond colonial-era frameworks that continue to shape institutions, policies, and ways of thinking.

At the centre of the session will be Amitabh Kant, former CEO of NITI Aayog and former G20 Sherpa, who will deliver the keynote address at the Multipurpose Hall of India

International Centre (IIC, New Delhi) on 7 May 2026 at 3.00 PM. His presence is expected to anchor the discussion around how India can transition into a self-reliant, confident nation by aligning economic growth with intellectual and cultural sovereignty. Kant is expected to outline a vision of a Viksit Bharat that is not only economically and technologically advanced but also rooted in its own civilisational ethos, emphasising the role of original thinking shaped by Indian contexts while engaging with global systems.

The session will examine decolonisation not merely as a symbolic exercise but as a structural and psychological

shift necessary for India’s future trajectory.

It will explore how dismantling extractive colonial economic models, reorienting legal systems towards a justice-centric approach, and overcoming entrenched intellectual frameworks are critical to shaping a more inclusive and self-determined development path.

The discussion will also reflect on the importance of aligning these shifts with broader national priorities as India moves towards becoming a developed nation by 2047.

Key themes of the deliberation will include economic transformation towards a value-surplus economy,

legal decolonisation through evolving justice frameworks, and intellectual sovereignty driven by initiatives such as the National Education Policy and the integration of Indian Knowledge Systems.

The conversation will further extend to questions of digital and strategic autonomy, particularly in the context of emerging technologies and the need to avoid new forms of dependency, while also aligning with the broader vision encapsulated in the Panch Pran. This Mantrana session is expected to serve as a platform for meaningful dialogue on India’s development narrative through an indigenous lens. MPOST

Markets rebound on buying in blue-chips stocks, political cues

In broader markets, BSE SmallCap Select index jumping 0.79 per cent and MidCap Select index by 0.75 per cent

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Benchmark Sensex rebounded by 356 points, while the Nifty settled above 24,100 on Monday, as buying in blue-chip stocks and state poll results trending in line with market expectations lifted investor sentiment.

The 30-share BSE Sensex climbed 355.90 points or 0.46 per cent to settle at 77,269.40. During the day, it jumped 997.25 points or 1.29 per cent to 77,910.75.

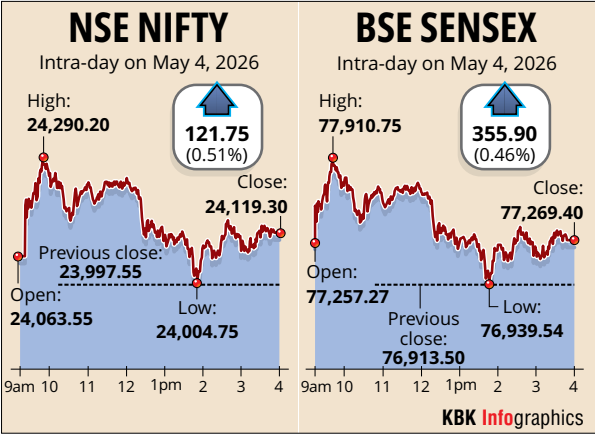
The 50-share NSE Nifty rallied 121.75 points or 0.51 per cent to end at 24,119.30.

From the 30-Sensex firms, Adani Ports, Hindustan Unilever, Reliance Industries, Larsen & Toubro, Eternal and Maruti were among the biggest gainers.

Bharti Airtel, Kotak Mahindra Bank, Tata Consultancy Services and ITC were among the laggards from the pack.

“Investor sentiment remained supported by a favourable election outcome in West Bengal and a better-than-expected Q4 earnings, helping markets look past Middle East-related concerns.

“However, intermittent profit booking persisted amid uncertainty surrounding the US ‘Project Freedom’ initiative to reopen the Strait of Hormuz,” Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Limited, said.



A total of 2,607 stocks advanced, while 1,735 declined and 216 remained unchanged on the BSE

While the resolution path may take time, optimism around gradual progress continues, he said, adding that crude prices holding below \$110 are providing near-term comfort.

Broader markets also advanced with the BSE Small-Cap Select index jumping 0.79 per cent and MidCap Select index by 0.75 per cent.

Among major sectoral gain-

ers, BSE Realty, Services, Capital Goods, Industrials, Healthcare and Utilities gained more than 1 per cent. BSE IT and PSU Bank were major losers.

A total of 2,607 stocks advanced, while 1,735 declined and 216 remained unchanged on the BSE.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 1.48 per cent to \$109.8 per barrel.

FII offloaded equities worth Rs 8,047.86 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data. Domestic Institutional Investors, however, were buyers as they bought stocks worth Rs 3,487.10 crore.

On Thursday, the Sensex tumbled 582.86 points or 0.75 per cent to settle at 76,913.50. The Nifty dived 180.10 points or 0.74 per cent to end at 23,997.55.

Asia, Pacific must build shared resilience: ADB



The bank expects growth in developing Asia and the Pacific to slow to 4.7% this year from 5.4% last year, while inflation is projected to rise to 5.2% from 3.0%

need for coordinated regional responses that go beyond national boundaries.

ADB is scaling up invest-

ments and reforms to help integrate infrastructure, markets and institutions across the region. In 2025, the bank extended \$29.3 billion in financial support and introduced measures to deliver assistance more quickly and at scale.

On Sunday, ADB unveiled a \$70-billion programme to strengthen regional security and resilience. This includes a \$50-billion initiative to develop a pan-Asia power grid aimed at integrating renewable energy, enhancing energy security and reducing emissions, and a \$20-billion plan to expand cross-border digital connectivity and bridge the digital divide.

Kanda said ADB has also moved swiftly to support member countries affected by the ongoing Middle East conflict, becoming the first development partner to offer financial assistance as economic pressures mount.

The bank expects growth in developing Asia and the Pacific to slow to 4.7 per cent this year from 5.4 per cent last year, while inflation is projected to rise to 5.2 per cent from 3.0 per cent. Prolonged disruptions from the conflict are likely to push up energy prices, tighten financial conditions and weigh on economic activity.

Under a more severe scenario involving further escalation and a spike in oil prices in May 2026, growth could slow to 4.2 per cent this year and 4 per cent next year, with inflation rising to 7.4 per cent in 2026.

Describing ADB as an “anchor of stability,” Kanda said the institution would continue to leverage its regional mandate and financial strength to address challenges such as mobilising private investment and tackling environmental degradation. AGENCIES

Petronet LNG posts record Q4 profit, recommends dividend of ₹3 per share

NEW DELHI: Petronet LNG Ltd reported its highest-ever quarterly profit in Q4 FY26, with profit before tax (PBT) at Rs 1,795 crore and profit after tax (PAT) at Rs 1,338 crore, driven by operational efficiencies.

PBT and PAT rose 24 per cent and 25 per cent, respectively, over the corresponding quarter of FY25, and surged 57 per cent and 58 per cent over the previous quarter. Overall LNG volume throughput in Q4 grew 7 per cent year-on-year.

During the quarter ended March 31, 2026, the Dahej terminal processed 201 TBTU of LNG, compared with 189 TBTU in the year-ago period and 214 TBTU in the December quarter.



Total LNG volume processed stood at 219 TBTU, versus 205 TBTU a year earlier and 233 TBTU in the previous quarter.

Despite the ongoing Gulf crisis, capacity utilisation at the Dahej terminal was 90.1 per cent, compared with 85.2 per cent in the year-ago quarter and 93.8 per cent in the preceding quarter.

For FY26, Dahej processed

833 TBTU of LNG, down from 876 TBTU in FY25. Overall LNG volume handled by the company stood at 901 TBTU, compared with 934 TBTU in the previous financial year.

For the full year, PBT was Rs 5,158 crore and PAT Rs 3,843 crore, slightly lower than Rs 5,275 crore and Rs 3,926 crore, respectively, reported in FY25.

In Q4, customers paid outstanding ‘use or pay’ dues of Rs 630.04 crore pertaining to CY2022.

The Kochi terminal recorded its highest-ever annual throughput of 68 TBTU in FY26.

The company’s board has recommended a final dividend of Rs 3 per share, subject to shareholder approval. MPOST

Sebi proposes changes to SDI rules to facilitate growth in listed securitisation market

NEW DELHI: The Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) on Monday proposed a set of changes to rules governing securitised debt instruments (SDIs), including permitting single-asset securitisation by RBI-regulated entities, easing structural restrictions and revising disclosure norms to deepen the market.

In a consultation paper, Sebi suggested exempting entities regulated by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) from the requirement that caps exposure to a single obligor at 25 per cent of the asset pool.

The move would allow list-



ing of single-asset securitisation deals, which are currently restricted under Sebi rules despite being permitted by the RBI.

The regulator also proposed replacing the requirement to wind up securitisation transactions if a trustee’s registra-

tion is suspended or cancelled with the appointment of a new trustee, noting that unwinding such deals is not allowed under RBI regulations.

To improve operational flexibility, Sebi recommended removing restrictions on securitisation transactions between an originator and a special purpose distinct entity (SPDE) within the same group, provided the originator is RBI-regulated.

Further, Sebi proposed shifting responsibility for periodic disclosures on the performance of the underlying asset pool from the originator to the servicer, which manages collec-

tions and monitors receivables. This is expected to ensure more timely and accurate disclosures to investors.

The regulator also suggested changes to the composition of SPDE trustee boards. For RBI-regulated originators, it proposed limiting representation to one member without veto powers, aligning with RBI norms to ensure arm’s length transactions.

Sebi said the proposals aim to harmonise its framework with RBI rules and support growth of the listed securitisation market. Public comments have been invited till May 25. AGENCIES

RBI and Irdai not in favour to allow insurers, banks’ play in commodity derivatives: Pandey

Sebi will issue an advisory to market intermediaries on risks from AI tools

MUMBAI: Sebi Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey on Monday said the banking and insurance watchdogs are not in favour of allowing entities regulated by them to invest in commodity derivatives.

“Banks and insurance companies — the respective regulators (RBI, Irdai) are not very favourably inclined to allow the banks and the insurance companies to invest in commodity derivatives and they have some valid rationale for it,” Pandey said during a fireside chat at

IMC Capital Market Conference 2026 in Mumbai.

He added that pension regulator in India had also looked at allowing pension funds to invest in commodity derivatives, but did not disclose whether it had made a decision.

Pandey said that Sebi will soon issue an advisory to market intermediaries on emerging risks from Anthropic’s Mythos and other artificial intelligence tools.

“We have engaged with all stakeholders in this and shortly

we are going to issue an advisory in terms of how they should really be very alert on the vulnerabilities that may be there and doing a proactive role in trying to do that,” Pandey said.

Further, he said India needs long-term capital and market-based finance. Investors need better choices. Market development and investor protection must therefore move together.

“Across all market segments, our effort has been to support growth while managing risk,” he added.

Recently, we have brought in changes to our process to facilitate a time-bound launch of funds by the AIF industry consistent with adequate oversight. This approach is especially relevant for debt markets, where the next phase must focus on issuer diversity, liquidity, and wider investor participation, he added.

A deeper bond market will complement equities and support long-term financing for infrastructure and enterprise, Pandey said. PTI

The R-factor

Rohit, Rickelton fire fifties as MI cruise past LSG

MUMBAI: Rohit Sharma (84) made a gratifying return from an injury-enforced layoff and Ryan Rickelton (83) gave another account of his hitting prowess as Mumbai Indians crushed Lucknow Super Giants by six wickets in their Indian Premier League match here on Monday.

Openers Rohit and Rickelton put on their third century partnership in the IPL -- this time 143 runs -- and laid the foundation for the much-needed win. MI overhauled LSG's 228/5 with 229/4 in 18.4 overs. After Nicholas Pooran made the most of some ordinary bowling from MI with a 21-ball 63, Rohit and Rickelton made merry during their 65-ball stand.

The former Mumbai Indians skipper Rohit had missed five matches due to a hamstring injury which he sustained while batting against Royal Challengers Bengaluru here on April 12.

But the 39-year-old showed no discomfort while clobbering seven sixes and six fours during his 44-ball knock, and Rickelton continued his rich vein of form with commanding stroke play around the park.

But Rickelton fell to Mohsin Khan in the 11th over, playing one straight to cover after a two towering sixes previously.

Rohit looked set for his third IPL ton but he top-edged impact sub Manimaran Siddharth (2/47) to be caught at short fine leg in the 14th over. Tilak Varma (11) failed to make a dent, while MI stand-in skipper Suryakumar Yadav (12)



Rohit Sharma and Ryan Rickelton stitched a 143-run opening stand

PTI

DC seek end to horror run

AHMEDABAD: Delhi Capitals will need to stop oscillating between sublime and suicidal to overcome their streak of three painful losses at home when they take on an equally desperate Chennai Super Kings in the Indian Premier League here on Tuesday. Both sides are on eight points from nine games and with five matches remaining, there is no room left for error.

The Capitals put up a clinical batting performance in Jaipur on Friday night to get a welcome win after a hat-trick of defeats. Two of those losses came at home causing immense hurt in the dressing room as Punjab Kings chased down a record 265 before Royal Challengers Bengaluru exposed their fragile batting against a potent pace attack. The defeats at Kotla also includes a harrowing one-run loss to Gujarat Titans, a game that DC should have definitely won.

AGENCIES

was once again caught near the ropes, instilling some nerves in the hosts. But Naman Dhir (23 not out) and Will Jacks (10 not out) completed the task.

In the Power Play, MI weren't off to a flier but 50 odd runs came off in first five overs. The hosts found the launchpad in the sixth when Avesh Khan

was pulverised for 21 runs by Rohit. The LSG seamer constantly missed his lengths and Rohit followed a couple of fours with as many sixes.

Rickelton, who began with a six off Mohsin over deep square leg, lit up the chase with compelling shot-making against pace and spin alike.

Earlier, Lucknow Super Giants rode on a whirlwind 20-ball 63 from Pooran to survive a mid-inning slowdown and post a par 228 for five.

Pooran cashed in on poor line and lengths from MI bowlers to pepper the on-side with eight sixes and a four in his minute-a-mile knock, which gave LSG the impetus along with Mitchell Marsh's 44 (25 balls; 4x4s, 3x6s) at the top.

AGENCIES

Debate grows over fair pay at Roland Garros



PARIS: A group of leading players including Jannik Sinner, Aryna Sabalenka and Coco Gauff have expressed "their deep disappointment" at the level on prize money at Roland Garros amid a lingering dispute with Grand Slam tournament organizers.

The clay-court Grand Slam event starts later this month in western Paris. The players said they have other demands that have not been addressed by officials, including better representation, health and pensions. The players' call came after French Open organizers announced last month the Roland Garros prize money has increased by about 10% for an overall pot of 61.7 million euros (\$72.1 million), with the total amount up 5.3 million euros from last year.

"Players' share of Roland Garros tournament revenue has declined from 15.5% in 2024 to 14.9% projected in 2026," the group of players responded in a statement on Monday.

Play begins on May 24 at Roland Garros. Men's and women's singles champions each receive 2.8 million euros and the runners-up 1.4 million euros. Semifinalists earn 750,000 euros and first round losers get 87,000 euros. Men's and women's doubles winners pocket 600,000 euros and the mixed doubles champions get 122,000 euros. But the statement said "the underlying figures tell a very different story," claiming that players receive a declining share of the value they contribute to generate.

"According to tournament officials, Roland Garros generated 395 million euros in revenue in 2025, a 14% year-on-year increase, yet prize money rose by just 5.4%, reducing players' share of revenue to 14.3%," they said. "With estimated revenues of over 400 million euros for this year's tournament, prize money as a percentage of revenue will likely still be less than 15%, far short of the 22% that players have requested to bring the Grand Slams into line with the ATP and WTA Combined 1000 events."

AGENCIES

Indian archers seek lost precision in Shanghai with Asiad on horizon

SHANGHAI: Indian archery heads into another major event clouded by poor planning, lack of direction and the absence of a full-time foreign coach, an alarming situation in an Asian Games year, as a strong field assembles for World Cup Stage 2 beginning here on Tuesday.

With the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan scheduled from September 19-October 4 approaching fast, India's build-up looks far from convincing. The season began with a disappointing outing at the World Cup Stage 1 in Mexico, where the only saving grace was a gold medal from the women's compound team.

That result did little to hide deeper concerns.

Despite competing in a depleted field, with powerhouse South Korea skipping the event, India's recurve archers failed to step up.

It turned into a reality check as none of the leading names, including former Olympians Tarundeep Rai, Atanu Das, Dhiraj Bommadevara, Deepika Kumari and Ankita Bhakat could reach the medal rounds.

Das and Dhiraj managed pre-quarterfinal finishes before bowing out. The men's recurve team, seeded 10th, suffered an opening-round exit after losing



Deepika Kumari will be eying redemption amid a hard season

PTI

The season began with a disappointing outing at the World Cup Stage 1 in Mexico to Spain in straight sets. The women's team cleared the first hurdle but went down to Turkey in the quarterfinals. In the individual section, Deepika, India's most decorated archer, exited in the second round.

Ankita, Simranjeet Kaur and Kumkum Mohod progressed one round further before losing in the third round. The mixed team pairing of Dhiraj and Kumkum also endured a forgettable outing, crashing out in the opening round to Brazil. Despite such an underwhelming performance, the national federation has retained the same squad for the first two World Cup stages, with selection trials for the Asian Games and the next World Cup legs slated in Sonipat from May 15.

As a result, India will once again rely on an ageing Tarundeep, an out-of-form Dhiraj, inconsistent Atanu and struggling veterans like Deepika and Ankita in Shanghai.

AGENCIES

Sinner eyes Rome return after Madrid run

MADRID: Fresh from making history in Madrid, Jannik Sinner wasted little time turning his thoughts to completing the 'Golden Masters' by triumphing on home soil in Rome next week -- which would make him only the second man to win all nine Masters 1000 titles.

The 24-year-old Italian became the first man to win five successive Masters 1000 crowns on Sunday after dismantling Alexander Zverev 6-1 6-2 in 57 minutes, adding Madrid to recent triumphs in Paris, Indian Wells, Miami and Monte Carlo. With only Rome missing from

his collection, Sinner will be hoping to go one better than last year when he was beaten in the final by Carlos Alcaraz in what was his first event back after a three-month doping suspension. Should he emerge victorious, he will follow in the footsteps of Novak Djokovic as the only man to have won all nine Masters titles.

"Playing at home is always special. Physically, I'm good and there is no reason not to play at Rome and I'm happy to be going to Rome; it's very special to me," Sinner told a press conference in Madrid on Sunday.

AGENCIES

Government of Maharashtra Directorate of Sports and Youth Services, Maharashtra State

Notice For E-Tender

Request for Proposal for Hiring of an Agency to Provide Sports Nutrition Supplements for Athletes under Mission Lakshyavedh Scheme.

Directorate of Sports and Youth Services, Maharashtra State, Pune is inviting Request For proposals from interested Manufacturer / Supplier through e-tender for Hiring of an Agency to Provide Sports Nutrition Supplements for Athletes under Mission Lakshyavedh at Shiv Chhatrapati Sports Complex, Mahalunge-Balewadi, Pune For the detailed Tender document, interested bidders should visit <http://mahatenders.gov.in> Tender submission would be online and the last date for submission of the proposals is 22nd May 2026 up to 04.00 PM

-Sd-
(Sheetal Teli - Ugale) I.A.S.
Commissioner
Sports & Youth Services
Maharashtra State

DGIPR/2026/27/579

UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

Letter No: 380

E-Tender Notice

Date: 04/05/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (E&M), Ichari dam invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below :
eTender No:-04/EE(E&M)Ichari dam/2026-27.
Name of work/supply/services etc.
SITC of discharge monitoring system at down stream for strengthening of EWS and for e-flow monitoring of Ichari dam.
Estimated cost : Rs. 9893218/- Plus GST extra
Date of availability of bid document on website: 05/05/2026 from 16:00 Hrs.
Last date for submission of bids on website: 26/05/2026 up to 16:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "<http://uktenders.gov.in>"
Executive Engineer (E&M) Ichari dam

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

Suryoday Small Finance Bank Limited
Regd. & Corp. office : 1101, Sharda Terraces, Plot 65, Sector - 11, CBD
Belapur, Navi Mumbai - 400614. CIN: L65923MH2008PLC261472.

POSSESSION NOTICE
Whereas The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of the M/s. Suryoday Small Finance Bank Ltd., under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (ACT NO.54 OF 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued a demand notice to below mentioned Borrower/s Guarantor/s. After completion of 60 days from date of receipt of the said notice, The Borrower/s / Guarantor/s having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower/s / Guarantor/s and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on them under section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 6 & 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on the date mentioned herewith:

Name of Borrower / Co-Borrower/ Guarantor	Date of Demand Notice	
257000017354, 1) MR. BALJEET SINGH S/O JAI SINGH 2) MRS. NARESH W/O JAI SINGH 3) MR. JAI SINGH S/O HARDWARI LAL	06.02.2026	
	Total Outstanding Amount in Rs.	Rs.1,04,97,787.19/- as on 05.02.2026
	Date of Possession	30.04.2026(Symbolic)

Description Of Secured Asset(S) /Immovable Property (ies) : **PROPERTY: 1 - ALL THE PART AND PIECES OF THE MORTGAGOR/S OWNER OF BUILT-UP PROPERTY BEARING NO.290, LAND AREA MEASURING 100 SQ.YDS., OUT OF KHASRA NO.44/11, SITUATED IN THE AREA OF VILLAGE NANGLOI JAT, DELHI AND COLONY KNOWN AS ASHOK MOHALLA, DELHI-110041 BY VIRTUE OF GIFT DEED VIDE REGISTRATION NO.6862, IN ADDITIONAL BOOK NO.1, VOL. NO.2878 ON PAGES 14 TO 20, DATED 12.08.2016 REGISTERED IN THE OFFICE OF THE SUB-REGISTRAR-II/A, PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI WHICH IS BOUNDED AS UNDER- EAST:- OPEN LAND, WEST:- GALI 15 FT., NORTH-PROPERTY NO.290, SOUTH: PROPERTY NO. 290-A, PROPERTY-II - BUILT-UP PROPERTY BEARING NO.290-A, LAND AREA MEASURING 100 SQ.YDS., OUT OF KHASRA NO.44/11, SITUATED IN THE AREA OF VILLAGE NANGLOI JAT, DELHI AND COLONY KNOWN AS ASHOK MOHALLA, DELHI- 110041 BY VIRTUE OF SALE DEED VIDE REGISTRATION NO.4042, IN ADDITIONAL BOOK NO.1, VOL. NO.2878 ON PAGES 14 TO 20, DATED 12.08.2016 REGISTERED IN THE OFFICE OF THE SUB-REGISTRAR-II/A, PUNJABI BAGH, DELHI WHICH IS BOUNDED AS UNDER- EAST : OPEN LAND, WEST GALI 15 FT., NORTH PROPERTY NO. 290, SOUTH : PROPERTY NO.292**

The Borrower/s / Guarantor/s in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the M/s. Suryoday Small Finance Bank Ltd, for an above mentioned demanded amount and further interest thereon.

Date : 05.05.2026, Place : Delhi **Authorised Officer, Suryoday Small Finance Bank Limited**

UJVN Limited
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun - 248006
Telephones: 0135 - 2763808, 2763809, Fax: 0135-2763507
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website: www.ujvn.com

पत्र सं०: 376

Tender Notice

दिनांक: 04/05/2026

Office of The Executive Engineer (Civil-I), Lakshwar Multipurpose Project, Dakpathar (Distt-Dehradun) invites sealed and separate tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders are given below:
Tender No. -01/EE (Civil-I)/LMP/2026-27
Name of work - "Repair and Maintenance of Lakhwar Bhawan-I at Dakpathar (Dehradun)"
Estimated Cost -Rs. 14,66,700/- (excluding GST)
Date & Time of availability of bid document on website -05-05-2026, from 10:00 Hrs
Last Date for submission of tender -25-05-2026, up to 16:00 Hrs
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The Tender documents can be downloaded from the NIGAM's website "www.ujvn.com".
Executive Engineer (Civil-I)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Amit S/o Raju R/o UT Jhuggi No. 182, Mangolpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **FIR No. 139/2024 u/s 392/411/34 IPC at P.S. Raj Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Amit** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Amit** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Amit** accused of **FIR No. 139/2024 u/s 392/411/34 IPC at P.S. Raj Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **05.06.2026**.

By Order: **Ms. Ibbani Aggarwal, Judicial Magistrate First Class-03, North-West, Court No. 107, First Floor Rohini Courts, Delhi.**

DP/5860/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person **Namely Arun Kumar S/o Shyam Lal Patel R/o A-216/217, Pakka Shahbad Dairy, Outer North, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 339/2020 U/S 379/411 IPC PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Arun Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Arun Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Arun Kumar** accused of **FIR No. 339/2020 U/S 379/411 IPC PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.06.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
DP/5863/ON/2026 **JMFC-05, Room No. 114, 1st Floor Rohini Court, Delhi**

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BERHAMPUR
(At/Po- Ambapua, Near Income Tax office, Berhampur-760011, Ganjam, Odisha)
(E-Mail :- serworh2004@yahoo.com, Tel No. - 0680-2404287)
NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH E-Procurement
Bid Identification No. Online Tender/01-2026-27/BPR

Identification No.	Name of work	No. of Works	Approx. Estimated Cost (In lakh)	Class of Contractor	Period of Completion
Online Tender / 01-2026-27/BPR	Road under Mukya Mantri Sadak Yojana (MMSY)	06 Nos	From Rs. 182.16 Lakhs to Rs. 423.07 Lakhs	"B" or "A" Class as applicable	Period of Completion as per Col. No. 5 of Annexure of NIT

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No	Availability of tender online for bidding
Chief Construction Engineer, R.W.Circle, Berhampur	Online Tender/ 01-2026-27/BPR	From 11.05.2026 at 10.00 A.M. to 25.05.2026 upto 5.30 P.M.

(i) EMD / Bid Security, Cost of Bid document is to be transferred through Online as per the procedure mentioned in the DTN.

(ii) Non-submission of the information/documents through online by the bidder as per the items mentioned in the eligible criteria of the DTN will also liable for rejection of his tender.

Further details & Corrigendum if any can be seen from the website: - **www.tendersorissa.gov.in**.

Sd/-
25001/25071/1/26-27/0002
Chief Engineer, R W Circle, Berhampur

ICICI Bank
Regd. Office: ICICI Bank Limited, Landmark, Race Course Circle, Vadodara- 390007
Corporate Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai- 400051.
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited shal Tower Plot No-23, New Rohtak Road Karol Bagh New Delhi-110005
Notice for Disclosure of Legal Heirs of Deceased Borrower
PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that Home Loan LBFD800002429922 (Credit facility) was granted to Sameer Shaurya Arora Of Borrower, Co-Borrower, Guarantor/Mortgagor (excluding deceased borrower) (Borrowers) along with the deceased Sudershan Surya Kiran Arora by ICICI Bank Ltd., (The Bank).

We would like to inform you that the demise of Sudershan Surya Kiran Arora has come to our knowledge during field visits conducted by the Bank officials and by telephonic communications on the registered contact numbers. In this regard, letter dated 30/April, 2026 was previously sent to the registered addresses of the Borrowers and the deceased Sudershan Surya Kiran Arora, for providing information about the Legal Heirs of the deceased Borrower.

Therefore, this Notice is hereby given for sharing details of the Legal Heirs of the deceased Sudershan Surya Kiran Arora with supporting documents for updating the Bank's records, within 15 days of publication of this Notice. You may submit the above-mentioned details to Raj Kumar by visiting Address: ICICI Bank Ltd Plot No.7, Community Centre S.D. Tower, Sector 8, Rohini New Delhi - 110085

Date : May 05, 2026
Place : Faridabad (Haryana)

SD Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Nitesh, S/o: Prem Lal, R/o: H.No-1, 439, A2 Greater Noida, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 814/2014, P.S. Mandawali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Nitesh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Nitesh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Nitesh of P.S. Mandawali, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.06.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sachin
JMFC-03, East Distt., Room No. 16, karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/5763/ED/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr. PC/)
84-Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Ramesh Kumar S/o Lt. Sh. Subedar R/o T-86, Sarai Kale Khan, Hazarat Nizamuddin, New Delhi** also at **Village & Post Behada P.S. & Tehsil Kerakat Distt: Jaunpur U.P.** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 595/2017 U/s 279/304A IPC at PS: Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ramesh Kumar** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ramesh Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ramesh Kumar of FIR No. 595/2017 U/s 279/304A IPC of PS: Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.06.2026**.

By Order
Rishabh Kapoor
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01 North, Court Room No.116, First Floor Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/5843/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Larry Samuel, S/o Samuel, R/o Chander Vihar, Nilotthi, Nangloi, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 641/2020, U/s: 279/304A IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Tilak Nagar, New Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Larry Samuel**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Larry Samuel**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Larry Samuel, FIR No.: 641/2020, U/s: 279/304A IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Tilak Nagar, New Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.06.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vikash Madaan
DP/5632/WD/2026 **Judicial Magistrate, First Class (Court Matter) Room No. 289, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shakir, S/o: Mohd. Ali, R/o.H.No.09,Gali No.17, C-Block, Shri Ram Colony, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.319/2019 U/S 25 Arms Act registered at P.S. Khajuri Khas, North East District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said **Shakir** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Shakir** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Shakir, accused of FIR No. 319/2019 U/S 25 Arms Act, P.S. Khajuri Khas, North East District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.06.2026**.

By Order, **Shruti Saraswat**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
DP/5851/NE/2026 **Court No.22, First Floor, North East District Karkardooma Courts, Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sakir, S/o: Nashir, R/o: F-2/523, Sunder Nagri, Nand Nagri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 577/2019, U/s: 12/9/55 G Act, P.S. Nand Nagri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sakir** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sakir** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sakir of P.S. Nand Nagri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.06.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
JMFC-03, Shahdara Distt., Room No. 19, 1st Floor, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/5587/NE/2026



Filmmaker Jon M Chu's 2018 film 'Crazy Rich Asians' turned out to be a hit

'DIDN'T THINK I DESERVED TO BE IN HOLLYWOOD'

LONDON: Filmmaker Jon M Chu didn't think he deserved to be in Hollywood until his film 'Crazy Rich Asians' turned out to be a hit, which he compares to winning a lottery. The director made his debut in 2008 with 'Step Up 2: The Streets'. His film 'Crazy Rich Asians' was released in 2018 and went on to gross over 239 million US dollars at the global box office.

"Why am I the person to tell the story? When you said my list

of movies, it lit up and you said 'Crazy Rich Asians'... That was a big point in my life. I didn't think I deserved to be in Hollywood. I was discovered and I got very lucky. And when you win the lottery, you think you actually don't know how you got there. So, you actually can't win the lottery again," the filmmaker said at a 'Canva Create' panel last month at SoFi Stadium, according to the entertainment magazine 'People'.

He added, "I had to learn how to win in a different way or how to tell my story. As I go through my career, that moment, choosing to do something that only I could tell was a scary... I was like, 'No one's going to see this movie'. I actually told my team. I was like, 'I'm going to make a movie. I'm going to take five years and I'm not going to make you any money'. Luckily, they were fine with it."

Featuring Constance Wu, Michelle Yeoh and Victoria Loke



among others, the film revolved around Rachel Chu (Wu), an NYU professor who travels to Singapore with her boyfriend, Nick Young, for a wedding, only to discover Nick is from one of Asia's wealthiest families.

His latest directorial is 'Wicked: For Good'. The film was released in 2025 and featured Ariana Grande, Cynthia Erivo and others.

The filmmaker compared it to winning a lottery

'Would love to direct another Thor film'

Kenneth Branagh isn't averse to making his comeback to the MCU



LOS ANGELES: Kenneth Branagh may have been busy with the multiple Agatha Christie cinematic adaptations. Still, he isn't averse to making his comeback to the 'Marvel Cinematic Universe' to direct another 'Thor' film.

The Oscar-winning actor-filmmaker, who currently stars as Meryl Streep's husband in 'Devil Wears Prada 2', last directed 2011's 'Thor' for the MCU. In an interview with the 'Business Insider', Branagh explained why he walked away from directing more superhero movies at the time.

"I definitely was ready for another, for sure, but not right then. 'Marvel' shoots are intense. 'Marvel' postproduction is more intense - wildly exciting but super intense. I

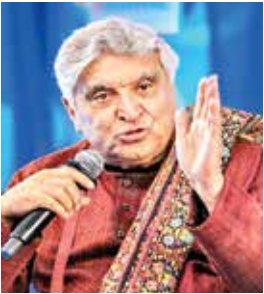
definitely needed to smell the roses. Kevin Feige was very understanding and so was the cast. I needed a break," Branagh said.

He added, "Part of me would love to finish my relationship with that character. I'd always wanted to do more and indeed had a couple of ideas, more in the territory of James Mangold's brilliant Logan. I would love to see Chris Hemsworth and the others have their own individual final story that takes Thor into a glorious twilight."

The actor believes it would be beautiful to take those characters to their own particular sunset.

The Oscar-winning actor-filmmaker currently stars as Meryl Streep's husband in 'Devil Wears Prada 2'

'Everyone has the right to promote ideas'



KOLKATA: Legendary lyricist-writer Javed Akhtar said everyone has the right to propagate his or her ideas in creative works. Akhtar was speaking to reporters after receiving a special award from a city-based leading jewellery brand for his achievement, when he was asked to comment on some recent films like 'Dhruandhar' being tagged as propaganda movies.

"I don't know what you mean by propaganda films. I loved 'Dhruandhar', which was an excellent film. I loved the first one more than the second one. Every story takes some stand, but does it become propaganda because the narrative isn't suited to a section of the audience? Everyone has the right to propagate their ideas. What is wrong with propaganda films?" he said.

Spike Lee praises Antoine Fuqua's film 'MICHAEL'

The film is the new biopic on 'King of Pop' Michael Jackson



LOS ANGELES: Filmmaker Spike Lee defended 'Michael', the new biopic on 'King of Pop' Michael Jackson, against criticism that it doesn't show child abuse claims against the late singer. Directed by Antoine Fuqua, the new biopic is a hit at the box office and features Michael Jackson's nephew Jaafar Jackson in the title role.

"First of all, if you're a movie critic and you're complaining about the stuff, all this other stuff, but the movie ends in 1988. The stuff you're talking about - accusations - happens later. So, you're critiquing the film on something that you want in, but it doesn't work in the timeline of the film. But people showed up. Worldwide, people showed their love," Lee told CNN.

The filmmaker said he misses Jackson, who died in 2009 at the age of 50 from acute propofol intoxication. "I miss Mike. I miss Prince. I mean, these are my brothers. I worked with both of them. Both beautiful, beautiful people."

Fuqua had also explained why he didn't include the allegations of child sexual abuse against Jackson in this movie, saying they planned to do a sequel to the story later.

"Unless you can truly take your time, let's go back to the beginning and really show people who he was on the stage. He's a superhero on the stage. Just like a human being, movies have the power of empathy to just say this is a human being. No one is perfect," Fuqua told 'Deadline'.

Lee defended against controversy over the exclusion of child sex abuse claims

ALCOHOL ADDICTION AWARENESS

Janhvi shares statement calling out misinterpretation OF HER COMMENTS

Janhvi Kapoor has been in the news for her recent initiative, which is focused on alcohol addiction awareness. The 'Dhadak' actress recently appeared on a podcast and spoke about the issue. However, the actress has now shared a clarification, saying that some of her recent statements were misinterpreted.

The clarification referred to statements she made during a conversation on Raj Shamani's podcast, where she spoke about a phase in her life when she was drinking more frequently following a deeply traumatic experience. The official statement, later shared by Janhvi on her 'Instagram Story', emphasised the context behind her words.

It read, "We at Off The Rocks & Amaha have noticed certain media pages misrepresenting content associated with this initiative and Janhvi Kapoor. This is deeply concerning."

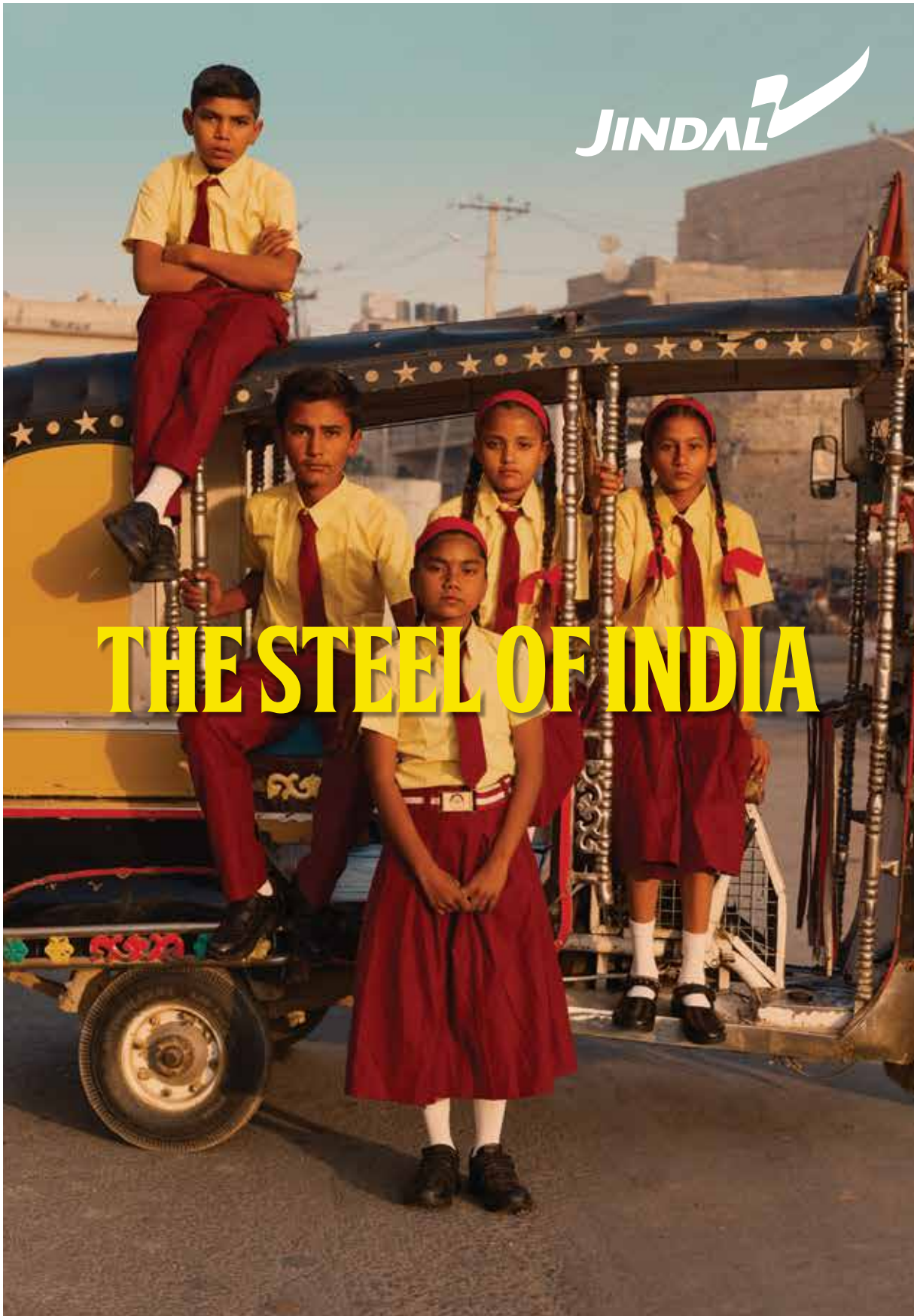
The note further clarified her role, stating, "We want to be clear, Janhvi Kapoor is part of this conversation as a caregiver and ally, not as someone who has had any personal experience of addiction or alcohol dependence. Such misrepresentation not only diminishes



In the podcast, she spoke about a phase in her life when she was drinking more frequently following a deeply traumatic experience

her role but also undermines and disrespects the real, lived experiences of those battling addiction and those supporting them. Let's not trivialise efforts to lend a healing hand to a critical problem by misleading information for the sake of clickbait."

The statement also urged media platforms and individuals to approach the subject responsibly, highlighting the need for sensitivity when discussing addiction.



THE STEEL OF INDIA